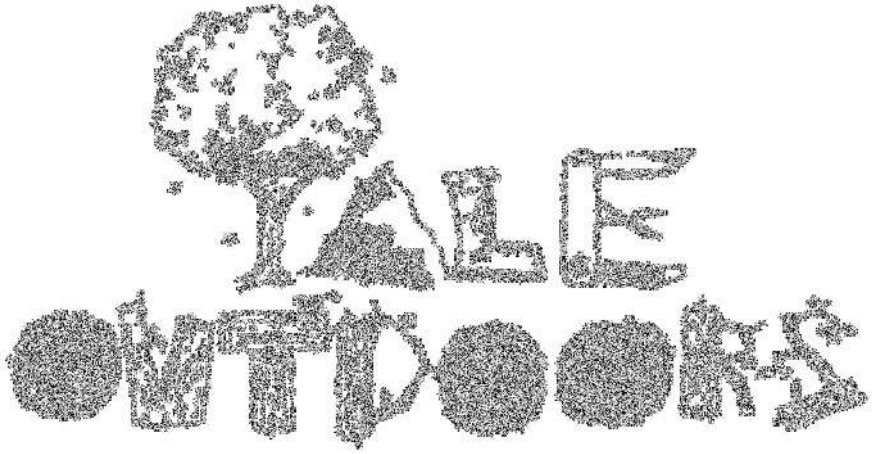


Yale Outdoors Prospectus
May 1, 2009

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I. Executive Summary

This prospectus outlines the state of outdoor life at Yale. It details the efforts of Yale Outdoors (YO), Yale Mountaineering Club (YMC), and other campus groups to make more opportunities for outdoor recreation available to the university community. These groups have worked in recent semesters to overcome the challenges of organizational fragmentation and a lack of resources.

Under a new organizational structure ratified in the spring of 2009, Yale Outdoors will now serve as an umbrella outing club at Yale, with primary affiliations to Yale Mountaineering Club and Forestry Outing Club, and developing secondary affiliations to groups like Freshman Outdoor Orientation Trips (FOOT) and the Yale Student Environmental Coalition (YSEC).

In the 2008-2009 academic year, these groups successfully collaborated in a number ways. They sponsored speakers on campus, arranged equipment and facility discounts at local outdoor vendors, led outing trips together, pooled gear together, shared privately fundraised money, and planned several educational events together. The signal achievements of this initial collaboration were the linking of the undergraduate and graduate outdoor communities; the pooling of some of the groups' gear in a common location; the raising of $20,000 in private donations to go toward the creation of an umbrella outing organization; and, most significantly, the successful execution of a major new outdoor education program: the first annual Winter School, a month-long series of lectures about winter recreation given by undergraduates, graduate students, and faculty members, and a series of winter trips around New England led by the same students.

These were important first steps in the reorganization and revitalization of outdoor life at Yale. More remains to be done. This prospectus is intended to serve as the basis of an ongoing conversation over several years between the leaders of Yale Outdoors, affiliated groups, and the Yale administration. It will be updated as need be over the course of this discussion. The leaders of Yale Outdoors welcome administrative input about this prospectus and further requests for information. A list of specific requests of the Yale administration is on page 100. In the short-term, the most pressing request is an appropriate gear room for the expensive gear now owned by YO. In the long-term, YO requests assistance in creating an endowment through alumni outreach and inclusion on the university development agenda.

II. Demonstration of Challenges

The opportunities for outdoor recreation at Yale are more limited than they should be. This is for two principle reasons: fragmented outing clubs and a lack of resources. As of the spring of 2009, the outing clubs have largely addressed the first challenge. The second remains.

A. Fragmentation

There are three registered outing clubs at Yale: Yale Mountaineering Club (YMC), Yale Outdoors (YO), and Forestry Outing Club (FOC). In addition, groups like FOOT, the club ski teams, and more informal groups engage in similar activities. Each group focuses on somewhat different activities, has a different history and administrative culture, and caters to somewhat distinct groups of people. Nevertheless, the overlaps are obvious. The most obvious costs of these overlaps are the following:

1. **Education redundancy:** Groups continue to offer Wilderness First Aid, CPR, and other courses separately. These are expensive, and their redundancy means that further outdoor education is often too expensive to subsidize.

2. **Gear redundancy**: YO, YMC, FOC, and FOOT have much of the same gear, but it has not been pooled in a central location, and so each group's gear acquisitions have remained relatively limited.

3. **Limited gear accessibility:** Gear owned by the outing clubs has usually been stuffed into the basements of residential colleges or the houses of club leaders. While in theory the whole Yale community is given the opportunity to use this gear, in practice it has been less than accessible. For several semesters, YO stored gear in closets in the music room of Berkeley College. YMC keeps some gear at a local rock climbing gym. FOOT keeps gear in the basement of a building at the top of Science Hill; these locations are less than ideal for groups with nearly weekly outings throughout the academic year. In the 2008-2009 academic year, YO and YMC had to move their gear three separate times as the storage needs of residential colleges (Berkeley and Davenport) changed. Without a stable physical home on campus, the outing clubs' gear is not being used the way it should be.

4. **Organizational redundancy**: Each group continues to organize its own events on campus (many of which are of interest to the wider outdoor community); manage its own gear; raise its own funds; run its own website; arrange its own transportation for outings; and negotiate its own discounts with local outdoor vendors. The time and energy of each group's leaders is being spent on largely similar issues.

5. **Hamstrung lobbying**: When it comes to lobbying the university administration, there is no united outdoor community voice. This makes it more difficult to get Yale funding for large events, to arrange alternative transportation options for outdoor trips, to resolve problems with Dining Services over meal plan swipes, and in general to receive administrative recognition at a level above that of any other club.

B. Limited Resources

In part because of the fragmentation of groups, each group has fewer resources. This means:

1. **Limited gear:** Gear is the highest cost for outing clubs. Under the current setup, with a maximum undergraduate club budget of $1,200 per year and modest rental fees and member dues, it is difficult to acquire sufficient gear for more than a limited range of outdoor activities. Even with preferential deals obtained as student organizations, purchasing items such as tents and backpacks still run hundreds of dollars per item.

2. **Limited transportation:** Outdoor trips are often cancelled because of the lack of a vehicle. Renting vehicles is usually cost prohibitive.

3. **Limited facilities:** With the closure of the student-managed Silliman Bouldering Room and the Yale administration's rejection of YMC's proposal in 2007 to build a replacement wall at Payne Whitney Gymnasium (including the rejection of a petition signed by 868 students; see the proposal on the next page), the outdoor community has been forced to pursue climbing at off-campus, private facilities, raising the costs of an activity once pursued for free on campus.

2007 Climbing Wall Proposal

On the following pages is the Yale Mountaineering Club (then the Yale Climbing Club) climbing wall proposal from the spring of 2007. This proposal is not a priority for YMC or YO as of the spring of 2009, but it is a demonstration of the shift in outdoor resources on campus in recent years, and the efforts of the outdoor community to alleviate the loss of those resources.

A Climbing Wall at Yale: Preliminary Proposal

March 28, 2007

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SUMMARY

"Sure, Yale's a great place. But does Yale have 4,000 feet of climbing wall? ...We didn't think so," Newsweek's Kaplan College Guide mocked Yale's conspicuous lack of university-wide climbing wall in a 2005 article. Indeed, Yale has been left in the shadows of the walls of Harvard, Princeton, Cornell, University of Pennsylvania, Stanford, Brown, and Dartmouth—to name just a few.

This absence is not due to disinterest at Yale. Elis have becoming increasingly vocal in their calls for a climbing wall since Silliman's climbing wall was taken down in April 2006. A petition circulated in fall 2006 and was signed by almost one thousand students. The Yale Climbing Club conducted a survey of 555 university students. An overwhelming 98% of students expressed a desire to use a climbing wall, and 95% were willing to pay for such a facility. In response, the Graduate and Professional Student Senate (GPSS) unanimously passed a motion and the Yale College Council separately passed their own resolution, both expressing support for the construction of a climbing wall.

Students' support for constructing a climbing wall is clear. In this report we include relevant background information on climbing, walls at other schools, and the former Silliman College climbing wall. More importantly, we provide a foundation for the administration to begin taking the steps towards the installation of a new wall that would be available to the entire Yale community and supervised to ensure safety. A committee can use this preliminary research to choose the ideal location on campus, find a contractor, choose a type of climbing wall, project a budget, and develop operational and safety guidelines.

It is worth addressing the initial reaction likely among liability-wary administrators: climbing walls are too risky. To ease these concerns, we urge you to consider the many ways scores of other universities with climbing walls have handled this. Universities around the country, and the majority of Ivy League universities, have found solutions to the operational and safety requirements of a climbing facility, and we are confident that Yale will do the same.

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I. Background

a. Popularity of Climbing

What was once called "The sport of the nineties" has demonstrated enduring power as one of the most popular new sports of our time. Although comprehensive lists of the facilities across the nation are not available, the Boston Globe estimates that there are as many as 1,000 climbing walls in the state of Massachusetts alone. Interest in the sport on the Yale campus has also been building. Over 550 students responded to a survey on the need for a new climbing wall, nearly 1000 students signed a petition of support for a new wall, and active interest is evident in all of the undergraduate colleges, graduate and professional schools and amongst faculty.

b. Benefits of Climbing at Yale

Here at Yale University, climbing can provide a safe but exciting activity. As a healthy and constructive recreational option, a climbing facility would help promote university goals such as limiting underage drinking. In addition, climbing offers participants more than simply physical benefits. It has been shown to increase concentration and confidence, to decrease stress, and to improve team-work and build trust.

The unsupervised climbing area open in Silliman College from 1996 to 2006 should not serve as a model for many aspects of a new, university-wide wall, but it did demonstrate that even a small facility could build community. The Silliman wall united an inclusive community of hundreds of undergraduates, faculty, staff and graduate and professional students. A University-constructed wall, available to the entire university community and staffed by trained student workers would open these opportunities to even more people in the Yale community.

c. History of Yale Climbing and Role of the Climbing Club to date

The following is excerpted from "Yale Climbers Find Serenity in High Places" (*Yale Bulletin & Calendar* 20 Feb 2004.[1] The Silliman bouldering wall referenced in the article was closed in the spring of 2006.

The Yale Climbing Club has existed in various forms at Yale since the University's earliest days, according to club president Alistair Anagnostou '05. Once called the Yale Mountaineering Club, the organization boasts alumni who have scaled (and in some cases were among the first to climb) some of the globe's highest peaks, including K2, the world's second-highest mountain and, arguably, the most difficult to summit. In fact, says Anagnostou, various noted rock-climbing routes around the world have been named after the Yale Mountaineering Club or after the Yale students or alumni who "set" the route for the ascent.

Over the years, the club has periodically become defunct until someone with a passion for the sport of rock climbing revives it, Anagnostou says. Such was the case over a decade ago when

[1] http://www.yale.edu/opa/v32.n19/story4.html

several Yale students got permission from campus officials to build the rock climbing wall in Silliman College. The climbing gym became even more popular several years ago when Anagnostou and his brother, Anthony Anagnostou '03 (the former president of the club), took on the task of doubling the climbing area of the gym with some help from other interested students. The gym -- which is open round-the-clock to all Yale students and faculty -- now serves as the principal training space for members of the Yale Climbing Club.

The Yale Climbing Club played the leading role in building, maintaining and operating the old Silliman climbing wall for the Yale Community for more than a decade. They developed their own operational and safety procedures that are outlined in the later sections of this proposal. Since the destruction of the Silliman wall in early 2006 due to dorm renovations, the Climbing Club has led the campaign for building a new wall on campus.

Summary of Club Activities

-Organize outdoor trips to regional climbing areas
-Maintained and operated Silliman climbing gym for over a decade
    - Operation included training of certified gym monitors in later years
    - See manual (Appendix 4)
-Recently launched Prime Climb Shuttle Service, a program which links campus climbers for rides to nearby for-profit climbing wall
-Host annual fall slideshow for members to share trips and plan new ones
-Host film screenings on campus
-Hosted Master's Tea with explorer and climber Conrad Anker (Silliman, 2006)
-Hosted fall outdoor top-rope party to introduce more students to climbing
-Maintain mailing list of over 400 for trip and event announcements

II. Need for a Yale Climbing Wall

a. Limited Climbing Options for Yalies Compared to Other Top Universities

After the closure of the Silliman wall, there is no Yale facility for climbing. Students interested in climbing must commute forty minutes to a commercial wall in Wallingford, CT, and pay between $12 and $15 per visit in order to climb. For those undergraduates without a car—the vast majority—there has been no convenient way to access even this facility.

Every Ivy League University except Yale either has a staffed climbing wall or is in the process of building one.

b. Students Call for Action

The results of a 2006 petition demonstrate strong support among the students and faculty for a Yale climbing wall. The signers petitioned the administration to construct a new climbing wall, citing that a wall provides a unique opportunity for physical training and social interaction. This petition was signed by 868 of students.

Student commitment to construction had been previously demonstrated in a survey designed by the Yale Climbing Club that was distributed by the GPSS to over 550 students. An overwhelming 98% of students expressed a desire to use a climbing wall, and 95% were willing to pay for such a facility. For detailed survey results see Appendix 2b.

Formal resolutions in support of the project have been passed by both the Graduate and Professional Student Senate (GPSS) and the Yale College Council (YCC). These governing bodies represent the full student body of graduate students, professional students, and undergraduates. The GPSS unanimously passed a motion in support of the project and expressing commitment to work with the administration. The motion cited the importance of a wall in improving student health and athleticism, aiding in intellectual endeavors and alertness through good health, and providing a historically important social and recreational outlet to the Yale community. The resolution concludes,

> We advocate the building of a new wall in a centralized location that will be available to students and faculty at no additional cost to their Yale tuitions or current fees. We are confident that this project upon completion will contribute to the university's goals of promoting health of students, a spirit of active interaction between all members of the university community, and maintaining our gym and recreational facilities as some of the best available university facilities in the world.

A Yale College Council Resolution also recognized the student desire for a new climbing wall.
The full text of both resolutions are included in Appendix 3.

III. Steps to Move Forward

a. Space: Choosing a Location

Almost any available space could be used to house a climbing wall. The previous climbing wall was located in the basement of Silliman College and helped serve the needs of a small climbing community for over a decade. In the hope of best serving the needs of the university, any new facility should be:

- Centrally-located and equally accessible to students and faculty in all residential colleges, graduate programs, and professional schools.
- In an area that allows for sufficient climbing space so as to ensure safety.
- Preferably indoors.

Possible locations include but are not limited to:

- Existing practice and exercise rooms in Payne Whitney Gym. The fifth floor is especially suitable as it offers a large wall (approx. 50ft x 25ft) with no windows.
- Light wells in Payne Whitney Gym.
- Athletic fields area.
- Any extension of, or addition to, existing athletic facilities.

Working with the university administration's inside knowledge of the spaces at Yale, we are confident that space will be found for a wall installation. Climbing wall design is highly flexible and facilities can be tailored to fit the needs and restrictions of any institution. Furthermore, because of the unique footprint and largely vertical space requirements, climbing walls integrate well into space shared among several user groups.

b. Construction: Finding a Contractor, Projecting Costs

There are numerous reliable contractors skilled in the area of climbing wall construction. We have provided several reputable companies and their contact information. We have listed more in-depth pricing information for the industry-leader (and most expensive option), Entre Prises. As the table below shows, there is a wide range of prices depending on the scale of the project.

The least expensive wall on the list was a $25,000 wall constructed for the New York Kidd's Club in 2005. The most elaborate and expensive wall listed is that of the University of Washington which boasts a 42-foot-wide bouldering wall and 5,822 square feet of indoor climbing, and cost $540,846. The various contractors would be able to work with the university to develop a design and project scale to best meet the needs of Yale University. The average price for Entre Prises walls built or planned in the last seven years was just under $200,000. However, those rates are by far the highest of any climbing wall construction company; there are excellent walls built on budgets half that size.

Climbing Wall Construction Companies

COMPANY	CONTACT	EXPERIENCE
Entre Prises USA, Inc.	20512 Nels Anderson Pl. Bend, OR 97701 P: 800-580-5463 F: 541-388-3248 www.epusa.com	20 years 3500+ walls
Eldorado Wall Company	Matthew Alford 1835 38th St. Boulder, CO 80301 P: 303-447-0512 F: 303-447-9191 www.eldowalls.com	10+ years Several hundred walls 46 university walls
Grip-It Adventures	Sean Cowherd Grip-It Adventures P: 877-510-2084 F: 410-918-0417 www.giadventures.com	10+ years Several hundred walls
Adventure Systems	PO Box8340 Elkridge, MD 21075 P: 877-595-4155 www.asclimbingwalls.com	10+ years 1000+ walls
Alpine Towers International	PO Box 69 Pineola, NC 28662 P: 800-706-0064 F: 828-733-3505 www.alpinetowers.com	
Rockwerx	39 Burnshirt Rd. Hubbardston, MA 01452 P: 978-928-4300 F: 978-928-1265 www.rockwerxclimbing.com	7 years
Experiential Systems	PO Box 188 Lansing, IL 60438 P: 877-206-8967 www.experientialsystems.com	24 years
Solid Rock Wall Systems	444 Via El Centro Oceanside, CA 92054 P: 978-355-6400 F: 978-928-1265 www.srws.com	15 years
Xcelsior Sysems	4640 Northpoint Blvd. Baltimore, MD 21219 P: 877-510-2084 www.xcelsiorsystems.com	12 years

Construction Costs for Recent Walls by Entre Prises

School/Organization	Cost	Date	Material	Status
University of Illinois Urbana-Champagne	225,000	Mar-07	Freeform	Projected
Principia College	70,000	Jun-07	Freeform	Projected
Ogden Rec Center	250,000	Nov-06	Freeform	Projected
University of Wisconsin Oshkosh	106,000	Jul-01	Imprint	Projected
South Indiana YMCA	60,000	Feb-08	Imprint	Projected
Princeton University	150,000	Jan-07	Imprint	Projected
Oklahoma Baptist University	100,000	Jun-07	Imprint	Projected
Hendrix College	95,000	Feb-07	Imprint	Projected
Federal Way	150,000	Oct-06	Freeform	Projected
Fristenburg Community Center	150,000	Oct-06	Combo	Projected
University of California San Francisco	200,000	Nov-07	Freeform	Projected
Austin Peay State University	125,000	Oct-06	Freeform	Projected
University of Akron	200,000	Dec-01	Combo	Completed
University of Illinois Chicago	149,000	Jan-01	Freeform	Completed
University of California Santa Barbara	167,304	Aug-04	Imprint	Completed
University of West Georgia	225,000	Mar-06	Freeform	Completed
Central Washington University	270,810	Oct-05	Freeform	Completed
Towson University	249,073	May-02	Combo	Completed
Appalachian State University	305,000	Dec-05	Combo	Completed
North West Branch YMCA	278,091	Jun-06	Combo	Completed
University of Pennsylvania	155,0230	Aug-02	Freeform	Completed
University of Washington	540,846	Mar-03	Combo	Completed
University of Idaho	438,000	Dec-01	Combo	Completed
University of Central Florida	195,027	Nov-01	Freeform	Completed
Youngstown State University	145,000	Jun-05	Freeform	Completed
Georgia Institute of Technology	131,617	May-04	Combo	Completed
Louisiana State University	120,000	Aug-04	Combo	Completed
Oregon State University	340,382	Dec-03	Combo	Completed
Kansas University	284,188	Aug-03	Combo	Completed
Southern Methodist University	248,000	Jun-05	Freeform	Completed
Middlebury College	123,421	Jan-02	Combo	Completed
NY Kidd's Club	25,000	Aug-05	Imprint	Completed
SW Oklahoma State University	130,000	Jun-05	Freeform	Completed
Average Construction Cost	**193,994**			

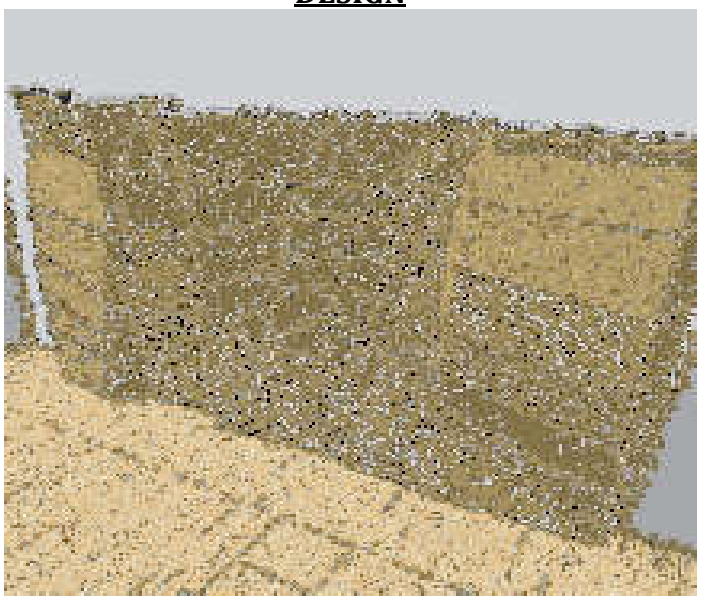


Akron University $200,000



University of Washington $540,846

DESIGN



BUILD



CLIMB



c. Operation: Developing Safety Guidelines, Selecting a Staffing Model

Safety and Liability

- **Methods of risk management:**
  University of Pennsylvania, Stanford, MIT, and Dartmouth all maintain trained staff for the monitoring of climbers during all hours of operation.

  Schools such as Cornell and Princeton require all climbers to sign liability waivers as a condition of facility use.

  The Climbing Wall Association, a non-profit, industry trade organization, offers services including: liability insurance, risk management consulting, staff training programs, and information regarding construction and operational standards. Additional information is available at: www.climbingwallindustry.org

Operation

- **Types of Staffing**
  The employment of trained staff, often experienced student climbers, ensures the safety of wall users and provides new climbers with the opportunity to learn necessary skills.
  Many facilities offer instructional courses or require that users demonstrate knowledge of basic climbing skills and knowledge of safety procedures.

- **Forms of Funding**
  The cost of maintaining a wall can be defrayed by student fees.

  Cornell, University of Pennsylvania and Princeton offer students the option of purchasing either single-use or semester passes to use the wall. Single-use passes typically cost around $5.00 while semester or year-long passes can be purchased for $50.00 to $80.00.

IV. Conclusion

In light of the high popularity of the sport, and overwhelming student demand, Yale should follow the other Ivies in constructing a climbing wall. This new wall should be open to the entire Yale community and supervised by trained student staff to ensure safety. Scores of universities around the country with climbing walls provide models for a range of possible solutions, all of which protect the liability and safety concerns of the college and provide a healthy, challenging recreational activity sought after by students. Ongoing expenses are relatively minor, and can be defrayed through the use of day-long or semester-long passes. University climbing walls work well in many different spaces, often making use of otherwise un-utilized vertical space. Putting the resources of a major university behind the project, Yale will limit risk for its students while maintaining recreational spaces commensurate with its world-class reputation. The Yale Climbing Club and Yale's student government representatives are excited to continue work together on this project with the University, and are happy to provide any necessary information. Please see Appendix 6 for a list of people to contact with follow-up questions or for additional information.

Appendix 1 – Newsweek Kaplan College Guide cited in Introduction

Newsweek Kaplan College Guide

Which Colleges Bring the Bling

Sure, Yale's a great place. But does Yale have 4, 000 feet of climbing wall? A pool with water slides? We didn't think so. A look inside the race to luxuriate.

2006 EDITION
By Devin Gordon and Joan Raymond
Newsweek

Posted Aug. 22, 2005 - Once upon a time, a typical college freshman's day would begin something like this: wake up in a creaky dorm room, step over your roommate's dirty laundry, then step over your roommate, slump down the hall to the bathroom and brush your teeth next to a total stranger, hit the gym for a quick run, then stop off at the cafeteria before class for a nice breakfast of runny eggs. It wasn't glamorous, but that was OK, because you were there for your *education.* And now? Put it this way: colleges no longer use icky words like dorm or cafeteria. These days, you'll get a funny look unless you say residence hall, recreation center or dining marketplace. It's all part of the sales pitch to make collegiate facilities sound as nice as possible. But it isn't just a pitch. All across the country, facilities devoted to students' extracurricular life *are* nicer than ever. A lot nicer. The lucky brats.

It's no secret that the admissions process has become as ferocious as Tom Cruise in a roomful of psychiatrists, but it's not just the kids trying to best each other. Now the universities are learning a new trick: if you can't beat 'em, luxuriate 'em. The University of Houston's new rec facility features an outdoor pool with waterfalls, water slides and a hot tub that seats 20. The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill just opened its $80 million Rams Head Center, complete with a 6,500-square-foot supermarket, a giant food court with actual, edible food and a state-of-the-art sports bar with remotes at each table connected to a series of wall-mounted plasma TVs. Ohio State University's sparkling $140 million facility boasts massage rooms and saunas, plus an Adventure Recreation Center with a bouldering cave and 4,000 square feet of climbing wall, which should give jealous Mom and Dad something nice and high from which to hurl themselves.

The students are justifiably thrilled with their lavish new surroundings—but they also expect it. Jed Johnson, a recent Ohio State graduate, says the new rec center addressed a desperate need. "It was totally weird that a major university had these horrendous facilities," he says. The school's old gym was "a maze. You could die in the hallways and no one would ever find you." From a marketing perspective, Ohio State had to upgrade or risk losing students and athletic recruits to—hiss!—rival Michigan.

At the University of Missouri-Kansas City, the administration just put the finishing touches on its first new residence hall in nearly half a century, the $22 million, 561-bed Oak Street Hall, a suite-style building wired for the digitally savvy freshman. The building should ease grumbling that the school couldn't compete with neighboring universities for out-of-town students until it addressed its meager housing situation. Like most new residence halls, Oak Street is a welcome departure from the psych-ward look favored by dorms of the past. "My mom says I'm spoiled," says junior Matt Franklin. "I always hear, 'Back when I was in school...' " Of course, back when she was in school, a dorm room didn't cost $6,270 a year, which is what students pay to live large in Oak Street—$1,000 more than students pay for a similar room in a nearby hall.

Construction-happy colleges rarely dip into their endowments to pay for their largesse. So where does the money come from? You. The schools borrow, then attach building-user fees to pay back the bonds. The downside is the risk of establishing class divisions on campus: the rich kids live in the fancy new digs. It's a risk, however, that colleges not only are willing to make but believe they must in order to compete.

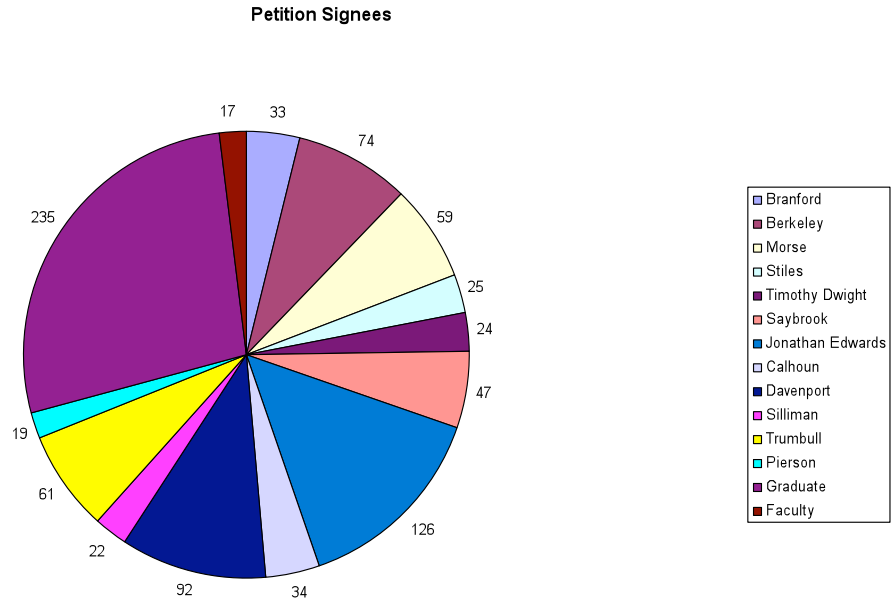
Some schools are even trying to woo students with, well, refreshments. On select Friday nights at Colby College, a private liberal-arts school in Maine, 21-and-older students can enjoy a nice South African Shiraz (and various microbrewed beers) served to them by a tuxedo-clad bartender. The wine tastings are part of Colby's alcohol-education efforts. For a dollar per varietal—cheaper than Schlit—undergrads get to drink the good stuff out of a crisp, clean wine glass. Enjoy it, kids. Once upon a time, all your elders had was a funnel.

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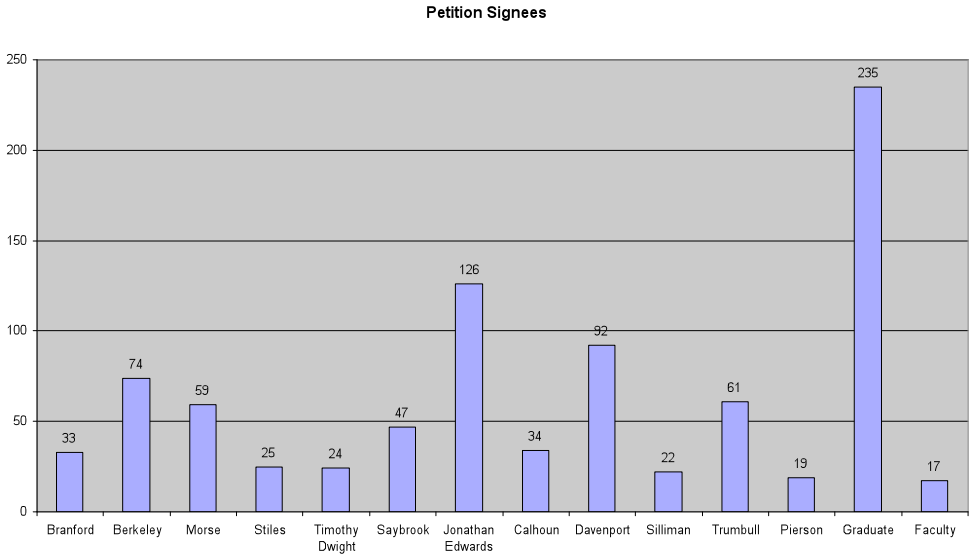
Appendix 2a

PETITION RESULTS

During the winter of 2007, the Yale Climbing Club organized a petition drive amongst Yale undergraduate and graduate students. The call for a new, on-campus climbing wall received support across all student divisions.



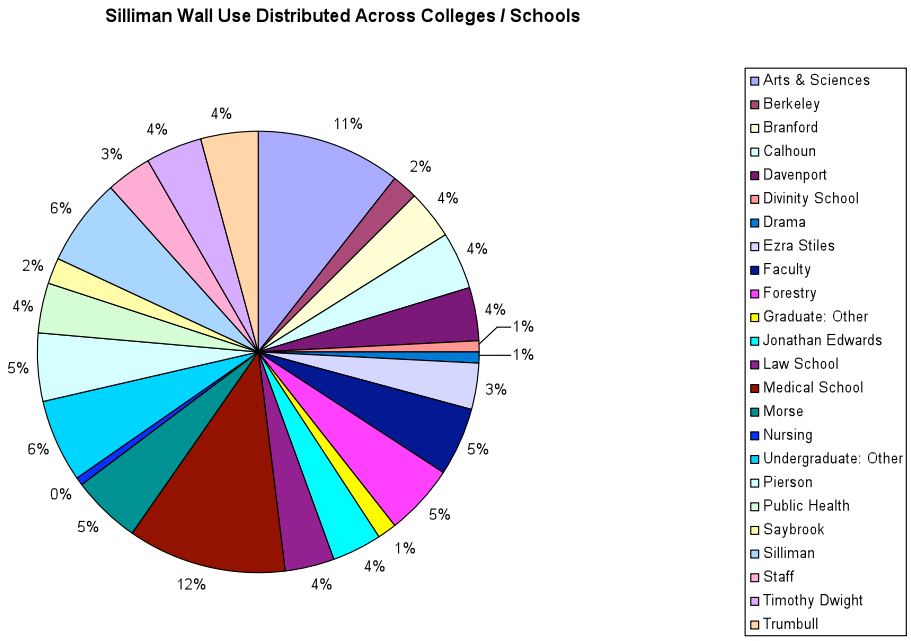
TOTAL SIGNATURES (March 30, 2007): 868



Appendix 2b – Survey Results

SURVEY

In the spring of 2006, the Yale Climbing Club conducted a survey of 555 Yale students and faculty to determine both patterns of past use and interest in the construction of a new climbing wall.



Findings:

According the survey:

- Use of the previous wall in Silliman College was evenly distributed across student divisions and included a significant number of staff and faculty
- **98%** reported that would use a climbing wall if Yale had such facilities
- **40%** of all students reported using the Silliman climbing wall
- **25%** of users reported using it at least once a week
- **54%** of users were undergraduates
- **38%** of users were graduate/professional school students
- **8%** were faculty or staff

Appendix 3 – GPSS and YCC Resolutions in Support of a Wall

i. GPSS Motion. Passed unanimously in the fall of 2006:

Motion in Support of New Climbing Wall Construction

We the Graduate and Professional Student Senate, advocate the construction of a new climbing wall at Yale University. The old climbing wall which was destroyed in the Silliman dorm renovations was an important part of the Yale recreational culture. We see the construction of a new climbing wall as bringing several advantages to Yale students and faculty:

- the ability to improve physical fitness and health
- the increased mental alertness and focus that good health can bring to intellectual endeavors and studies
- returning an important recreational and social outlet which has historically brought together hundreds of undergraduate, graduate and professional students along with faculty in the Yale community

We advocate the building of a new wall in a centralized location that will be available to students and faculty at no additional cost to their Yale tuitions or current fees. We are confident that this project upon completion will contribute to the university's goals of promoting health of students, a spirit of active interaction between all members of the university community, and maintaining our gym and recreational facilities as some of the best available university facilities in the world.

ii. Yale College Council Resolution. Passed October 26, 2006:

Resolution of the Yale College Council
Topic: Climbing at Yale
Author: Michael Ma
Sponsors: Robert Baskin, Danielle Carter, Rebecca Taber, Jonathan Wu, Danny Seifert, Taylor Matthews
Date: October 26, 2006

A Resolution Concerning Climbing at Yale

Whereas, students at Yale have expressed an interest in having a climbing wall at Yale, and

Whereas, Yale currently has no climbing wall to support students interested in climbing at Yale, and

Whereas, a great deal of students surveyed have expressed that they enjoyed the Silliman climbing wall, which was taken down on April 23, 2006, and

Whereas, a student survey by the Yale Climbing club found that 218 of 555 students surveyed had used the climbing wall (a percentage of 40% of surveyed), with 25% of those who used the climbing wall using it at least once a week. Also, 542 students out of 555 surveyed expressed a desire to try out climbing if Yale had the facilities to accommodate them, and out of those students, an overwhelming percent (95%) expressed a willingness to pay for such a facility, and

Whereas, there exists an active group of students specifically interested in this issue, who are willing to fundraise to build such a wall and volunteer as CPR-certified monitors if such a wall is built, and

Whereas, the location (possible locations include the third or seventh floor of Payne Whitney) and cost of such a climbing wall is completely feasible (minimum of $10,000, with possibility of fund raising to cut costs even below that).

The Yale College Council Resolves that:

1. Yale will look into the feasibility of having a climbing wall built.
2. If feasible, the YCC will express its support for the construction of a climbing wall in an easily accessible area for all students.

Appendix 4 -- Liability Waiver for now defunct Silliman Climbing Wall

Liability Release, Waiver, Discharge and Covenant Not to Sue

This is a legally binding Release, Waiver, Discharge and Covenant Not to Sue (collectively, "Release"), made voluntarily by me, the undersigned Releasor, on my own behalf, and on the behalf of my heirs, executors, administrators, legal representatives and assigns (hereinafter collectively, "Releasor," "I" or "me", which terms shall also include Releasor's parents or guardian, if Releasor is under 18 years of ages) to Yale University and the Yale Climbing Club

As the undersigned Releasor, I have read and understood the rules of the Bouldering Gym. I fully recognize that there are dangers and risks to which I may be exposed in utilization of the Bouldering Gym. I also acknowledge the risks involved in climbing without a helmet, and I personally accept any risks resulting in not wearing a helmet.

As the undersigned Releasor, I understand that Yale University does not require me to participate in utilization of the Bouldering Gym, but I want to do so despite the possible dangers and risks and despite this Release. With informed consent, and for valuable consideration received including assistance provided by Yale University, as the undersigned Releasor, I agree to assume and take on myself all of the risks and responsibilities in any way arising from or associated with this activity, and I release Yale University, the Yale Climbing Club and all of its affiliates, divisions, departments, and other units, committees and groups, and its and their respective governing boards, officers, directors, principals, trustees, legal representatives, members, owners, employees, agents, administrators, assigns, and contractors (collectively "Releasees"), from any and all claims, demands, suits, judgments, damages, actions and liabilities of every name and nature whatsoever, whenever occurring, whether known or unknown, contingent or fixed, at law or in equity, that I may suffer at any time arising from or in connection with the activity, including any injury or harm to me, my death, or damage to my property (collectively "Liabilities"), and I agree to defend, indemnify, and save Releasees harmless from and against any and all Liabilities.

As the undersigned Releasor, I recognize that this Release means that I am giving up, among other things, all rights to sue Releasees for injuries, damages or losses I may incur. I also understand that this Release binds my heirs, executors, administrators, legal representatives and assigns, as well as myself. I also affirm that I have adequate medical or health insurance to cover any medical assistance I may require.

I agree that this Release shall be governed for all purposes by Connecticut law, without regard to such law on choice of law.

I have read this entire Release. I fully understand the entire Release and acknowledge that I have had the opportunity to review this Release with an attorney of my choosing if I so desire, and I agree to be legally bound by the Release.

THIS IS A RELEASE OF YOUR RIGHTS, READ CAREFULLY AND UNDERSTAND BEFORE SIGNING.

(Releasor's Signature) (Parent's Signature, if Signatory is minor)

(Print Name) (Print Name)

(Date)

I also understand that while the Bouldering Gym does not require me to use a helmet while climbing, the use of a helmet will reduce the risk of serious injury during bouldering and other climbing activities. I am aware that the Climbing Club offers to me, free of charge, the use of a helmet and that I can request one at any time during my use of the Bouldering Gym

(Releasor's Signature) (Parent's Signature, if Signatory is minor)

Appendix 5 –

Silliman Climbing Wall Rules and Regulations 2005-2006

1. Hours of Operation:

The Bouldering Gym will be open at the times posted on the website. Gym monitors will be available by e-mail or phone to open the Gym at any other time, provided that they are available. These are the only times the Bouldering Gym will be open for use by boulderers. A staff member must staff the Bouldering Gym anytime the gym is open.

2. Rules:

All participants, observers, and staff must abide by the rules. The rules will be prominently displayed within the Bouldering Gym at all times. Individuals violating the Bouldering Gym rules will be warned appropriately. The Bouldering Gym staff reserves the exclusive right to expel any individuals failing to abide by the rules. The rules for the Bouldering Gym are as follows:

1. All boulderers must check in with the on-duty staff member.
2. All boulderers must pass a spotting proficiency class and complete a Participant Agreement, Release, and Acknowledgement of Risk
3. Any minor must have the Participant Agreement signed by a parent or guardian.
4. Parents are responsible for the actions of their children.
5. Absolutely no drugs or alcohol are allowed at the Bouldering Gym. If you have been consuming any such substance, remove yourself from the premises. The Campus Police will be summoned if you do not.
6. Please remove all jewelry, watches, keys, etc. These objects can cause injury to you and/or your spotter(s). These objects are also bad for the crash pads.
7. Never climb alone! You must ALWAYS have a spotter, who has completed the spotting class offered at the Bouldering Gym, and there must always be a staff member present in the room.
8. PAY ATTENTION! If you are spotting a climber, your responsibility is to guide the person in the event of a fall. Not being attentive to the boulderers every action/movement can result in injury to you, the climber, or others.
9. Only boulderers on routes, spotters guarding boulderers on route, and staff members may be in the climbing area of the Bouldering Gym. If you are not one of the afore mentioned parties, you must remain in the warm-up/registration area of the Bouldering Gym. Failure to do so may result in injury to yourself or others at the Bouldering Gym and will lead to immediate removal.
10. The Bouldering Gym is not responsible for lost or stolen articles.

3. Instruction:

The Yale University Bouldering Gym and its staff will provide Introduction to

Spotting class on a regular basis during the weekends depending on the demand for the class. The sign-ups and times for the classes will be posted on the bulletin board outside the Bouldering Gym. The classes will be limited to 6 people per session and will be run by at least one staff member. An outline of the spotting instruction can be found in the "Staff" section of this manual. Upon successful completion of the class and passing of the safety check, an individual will be allowed to spot or climb in the Bouldering Gym.

4.Maintenance Inspections and Documentation:

Before the wall is opened each night, the wall should be inspected, as outlined in Section IV, Item 1, for any maintenance problems. It is within the discretion of the staff member on duty whether to open the Bouldering Gym if a maintenance problem is found. Any problem should be reported immediately to the Bouldering Gym manager(s).

III.Staff

The Bouldering Gym will be staffed at all times, when open. The Yale University Bouldering Gym Staff member may spot boulderers as necessary. If there are not enough spotters available, the other boulderers must wait for the Bouldering Gym staff member to become available.

The Yale Climbing Club and the Bouldering Gym Staff members reserve the exclusive right to expel any person from the facility, who is not following the rules, posted at the Bouldering Gym, or for any other legitimate reason. If a person refuses to leave, the Bouldering Gym staff is encouraged to call the Campus Police. The Yale University Bouldering Gym staff member has the right to cease operation of the Bouldering Gym, and close the wall for any reason. Participants must leave the Bouldering Gym when instructed to do so by a Bouldering Gym staff member

1.Schedule

The staffing schedule will be posted on the bulletin board inside the Bouldering Gym and online. If a staff member cannot make a scheduled Bouldering Gym operation time, he/she should notify the climbing-wall manager immediately.

2.Duties and Responsibility, Roles

The responsibility of the staff is to maintain a safe environment for participants at the Bouldering Gym. The staff is also responsible for teaching proper spotting methods. It is the mutual responsibility of the Bouldering Gym Staff and the participants of the wall to conform to proper safety measures at all times, as outlined in this document.

3.Staff Meetings

Staff meetings will be arranged as necessary to discuss any concerns that the staff has.

4.Office Procedures

The staff of the wall should file all Participant Agreement, Release, and Acknowledgement of Risk forms, alphabetically in the filing cabinet. Every

participant entering the Bouldering Gym should be checked to ensure the individual has passed the safety check and has a signed Participant Agreement, Release, and Acknowledgement of Risk on file. Each staff member must read, sign, and file, a Participant Agreement, Release, and Acknowledgement of Risk form.

5.Activity Log

Whenever the Bouldering Gym is open, the staff should track numbers of individuals climbing. It is suggested that there is a sign-in/sign-out sheet kept at the desk. At the end of each climbing period, the staff members should tally the number of boulderers and record the number in the activity log.

6.Alcohol and Drug Policy

Staff members of the Bouldering Gym who consume drugs or alcohol are a liability to all individuals at the Bouldering Wall. Any staff member will be dismissed immediately, if s/he is determined by the manager(s) to be consuming such substances during hours of operation or if s/he is under the influence of illicit drugs or alcohol.

7.Qualifications

To be a staff member at the Yale University Bouldering Gym, there are certain qualifications. These qualifications include:
1.Current CPR/First-Aid certification (from Red Cross, AHA, or similar organization)
2.Satisfactory completion of the spotting instruction course.
Upon completing the spotting instruction course as outlined below, the Bouldering Gym Staff candidate will be
reviewed by the Yale Climbing Club, which reserves the right to accept or reject a given candidate.

Safety Program and Documentation

1.Equipment Inspection

Responsibilities

Before the wall opens every night, the staff member present should take time to do an inspection of the wall. It is suggested that the staff member look at the previous week's entry in the maintenance log. It is up to the discretion of the staff member to open the wall. An inspection should include, but is not limited to, insuring the landing pads are properly positioned, examining the Bouldering Gym structure for wear and/or damage.

2.Spotting Script (including safety orientation)

Script for an instruction class for spotters:
Overview: The spotting class will last approximately one hour. The first half of the class will be instruction and demonstration by a trained Bouldering Wall staff member. The second half hour will be for practicing techniques just learned.

1. Introduction to the facility and explanation of bouldering
    a. Instructor shows around the wall, pointing out vertical and overhanging sections.
2. Explanation of purpose and style of bouldering: Short climbs, no ropes: Every fall is a ground fall
3. Safety features of the gym
    b. Instructor points out mats. Explains that they should be clear of all items (e.g. food, drink, gear, shoes, people) that could potentially cause a falling climber to injure his or her ankle or back.
    c. Spotting
4. Instructor talks about what spotting is, why it is used, when it should be used and how it should be performed.
    d. This is approximately what the instructor has to say:
        i. About spotting in general:
            1. Spotting is a crucial part of climbing extreme bouldering routes. The goal of a spotter is not to catch a bouldering climber when they fall, but to break their fall to prevent a serious head injury and steer them into a safe landing. Assume a solid stance on the ground, with legs slightly bent, and arms outstretched towards the climber and slightly bent, ready to break a fall. If the situation could result in a potentially dangerous fall, get two or even three spotters to break the climber's fall. This is more of a concern in outdoors scenarios with taller boulders.
        ii. About spotting priorities:
            1. Your highest priority is to protect the boulderer's head and spine.
            2. The next priority is to steer the boulderer toward a good landing.
            3. Last, if possible, reduce the force of the boulderer's fall.
            4. To spot well, know the problem and anticipate the moves. Focus on the boulderer's center of gravity. With most men this is a few inches above the belt line. With most women, it is at the belt line. Don't make the mistake of watching hands, arms, feet, or legs. These tend to fly about giving the appearance that the climber is falling, even though he or she may still be hanging on.
        iii. About spotting technique for vertical walls:
            1. climber will usually fall feet first from a vertical wall. Grab the boulderer by the hips and steer him to a good landing. Absorb some of the fall with your arms and legs. The boulderer absorbs the rest of the impact with his or her legs. [Instructor demonstrates position].
        iv. About spotting technique for overhanging walls:
            1. When falling off overhangs the body often falls at an angle to the ground, instead of feet first. In these hazardous cases

grab further up the body (above the center of gravity), along the upper lats or underarm. This will cause the body to rotate feet downward. Steer the climber to a good landing and absorb the impact as above. [Instructor demonstrates the technique with a partner].

v. About common sense and judgment of situation:

1. Sometimes the best a spotter can do is push the falling climber away from danger and into a safer landing position. This is more of a concern for outdoors bouldering. However, even in the gym, one should always make sure that the safety rules are being followed, and no danger is created. Overzealous spotting is preferred to no spotting, but you should not support the climber while he or she is still on the problem - your job as a spotter is to break the climber's fall when he or she is falling.

5. Instructor repeats safety rules:
   e. Keep mats clean and clear of all items
   f. Keep clear of area if not spotting (i.e. don't walk underneath a climber)
   g. Use caution when climbing and don't climb in each other's way
   h. As a climber, be aware of your body position so you can land safely on your feet
   i. Use a spot if you need it
   j. Use common sense and good judgment and be aware of your surroundings

6. Practice spotting

   Instructor oversees:

   Scenario 1: Feet-first fall from a vertical wall
   Scenario 2: Fall from an overhang
   Scenario 3: Fall from a weird position overhanging (climber remembers to be aware of his or her position and try to land safely, spot remembers to steer to safe landing)
   Scenario 4: Two spotters working together (making sure they know each other's responsibilities)

**This 2005 manual was written based on the regulations of the MIT Outing Club. By allowing the Yale Climbing Club to use the MITOC manual, with the exception of certain references to the names of organizations, MITOC has made possible the reopening of Silliman Gym. We are grateful to them.

Appendix 6 – People to Contact for Further Information

For general information or questions about the content of this proposal:

John Muse
PhD Candidate, Yale English Department
john.muse@yale.edu
(203) 824-0050

For questions about the Yale Climbing Club and recent surveys:

Christopher Baker
Yale Class of 2009
President of the Yale Climbing Club
christopher.baker@yale.edu
(304) 638-8596

For climbing-specific questions, or questions about Stanford University's wall:

Dennis Murphree
PhD Candidate, Yale Physics Department
dennis.murphree@yale.edu
(210) 323-8664

GPSS Advocate:

Anna Stirgwolt
Advocate, Graduate and Professional School Senate
PhD Candidate, Yale Engineering Department
anna.stirgwolt@yale.edu
(410) 241-3297

For questions about Silliman's involvement in the Silliman Bouldering Wall:

Judith Krauss
Master of Silliman College
judith.krauss@yale.edu
(203) 432-0700, (203) 737-2537

III. Demonstration of Larger Plans

Summary: What has already been done

In response to the issues above, in the fall of 2008 the outing clubs began changing the way they operate. Leaders of the different groups started meeting regularly to discuss the possibility of a new organizational structure. They began collaborating on joint projects, such as bringing speakers to campus, arranging discounts at local outdoor vendors, and planning educational programs. They also met on several occasions as a group and as individuals with the Dean of Student Affairs, Marichal Gentry, and the Assistant Dean of Student Affairs, Edgar Letriz, about how to reorganize and receive greater administrative support. The signal achievements of this initial collaboration were the linking of the undergraduate and graduate outdoor communities; the pooling of some of the groups' gear in a common location; the raising of $20,000 in private donations to go toward the creation of an umbrella outing organization; and, most significantly, the successful execution of a major new outdoor education program: the first annual Winter School, a month-long series of lectures about winter recreation given by undergraduates, graduate students, and faculty members, and a series of winter trips around New England led by the same students.

These were important first steps in the reorganization and revitalization of outdoor life at Yale. However, these efforts have not yet been formalized into a new structure for the outing groups. And the problems above remain problems.

Umbrella Reorganization

In April 2009, Yale Outdoors adopted the new umbrella structure described below. Over the course of the next two years, more detailed parts of this plan will be implemented and YO will reach out to other groups that might be interested in affiliation.

Assumptions

1) Collaboration is good. More collaboration is better.

2) Bylaws have longer memories than students. Student turnover can be mitigated by clear but flexible bylaws.

3) A minimal necessary amount of structure is better than a more complicated structure.

4) Build it so that they can come. Restructuring the outing clubs can only make it easier for students to create new outdoor opportunities; it cannot itself create those opportunities.

Basic Plan

Rather than creating a new umbrella organizational structure above the existing outing clubs, it makes the most sense to restructure Yale Outdoors in order to combine some of its functions with Yale Mountaineering Club.

In effect, this will increase the size of YO and decrease the size of YMC independent of YO. In addition, formal affiliations will be established with groups related to this effort, including FOC and the larger graduate community, FOOT, and the Yale Student Environmental Coalition (YSEC). Two overarching objectives are: to increase the opportunities of the Yale community to explore the outdoors; and to address the specific problems listed above. With these objectives in mind, new roles and board positions will arise within Yale Outdoors. However, each present group will maintain its current registered status as either an undergraduate or graduate club. Some overlapping activities will be fully transferred to YO, formal liaison positions will be established, and YO will be recognized as the umbrella outdoor organization on campus.

Old Stucture

The board of Yale Outdoors has for at least a decade consisted of six positions: two co-coordinators, a treasurer, a gear manager, an on-campus events coordinator, and a graduate liaison. The board of Yale Mountaineering Club was reorganized in 2008-2009 to consist of nine positions (with some officers holding more than one position—for example, in the spring of 2009 6 officers filled the 9 roles): a president, a treasurer, a gear manager, a trips coordinator, an education coordinator, an events coordinator, an expedition coordinator, an historian, and a secretary/publicist.

New Structure

A stronger outing club presence on campus would consist of four main components:

- **Physical**: a permanent gear room and office
- **Virtual**: a consolidated website
- **Events**: a regular schedule of events; for example, annual Winter Schools, Earth Week celebrations, and wilderness medicine courses
- **Media**: weekly e-mail newsletters; occasional newspaper editorials; annual alumni newsletters

The following would seem to be the main roles of a restructured umbrella outing club:

- Outdoor activities (e.g. hiking and snowshoeing, climbing and mountaineering, canoeing and kayaking, skiing, mountain biking, surfing)

- Communication among outdoor communities (e.g. between outdoorspeople in the Forestry School and in the College)
- Outdoor trip scheduling
- Gear acquisition
- Gear room management (including rental procedures, staffing, etc.)
- Outdoor leader education (wilderness medicine, avalanche safety, etc.)
- Club membership management (dues, member lists, member identification (e.g. stickers))
- Discounts for club members at local vendors (e.g. Trailblazer, Ascent, CT Rock Gym)
- Winter School coordination
- Coordinating other campus events
- Administrative lobbying (e.g. event funding, dining hall problems, transportation possibilities)
- Alumni relations and fundraising
- Endowment creation and management (long-term)

With these roles in mind, the officers on the board of Yale Outdoors might fill the following roles:

- Two **Co-Coordinators**: ideally but not necessarily interested in different outdoor activities; will run meetings and handle most correspondence; will oversee any activities not listed below, or will fill in for activities when required; will be a point person for lobbying the administration

- **Treasurer:** manage the bank account; apply for funding; cut checks

- **Publicist**: in charge of all publicity (including advertisements in campus publications, Facebook groups and events, etc.), merchandising, advertising relationships, and potentially weekly newsletters

- **Gear Manager**: in charge of the gear inventory and other gear room documentation; scheduling gear room hours; finding staff for gear room hours; and holding a session for YO leaders each semester to explain gear procedures

- **Webmaster**: in charge of umbrella website for YO and YMC, and potentially FOC and other groups

- **Winter School Coordinator(s)**: in charge of organizing Winter School, including arranging lecturers for each topic, reserving lecture space, and facilitating trips

- **Membership Coordinator**: in charge of the procedures for membership (fee collection and the maintenance of a membership list), recognition of membership (whether with stickers on Yale ID cards or a separate membership card), and discount relationships with local vendors

- **Events Coordinator**: in charge of all on-campus events besides Winter School and including educational courses like Wilderness First Aid

- **Alumni Liaison**: in charge of maintaining a list of alumni, organizing fundraising letters and annual newsletters, and serving as a liaison to an alumni organization (following the creation of this organization)

- **Historian**: in charge of maintaining the archives of the club and relevant affiliates; corresponding with university offices (the library, the dean's office) for archival material; and promoting institutional memory within the club, including encouraging the completion of trip reports

- **Affiliated Liaisons**: each group affiliated with YO will have one designated point person in charge of communicating between the groups and attending relevant meetings (e.g. YMC, FOC, FOOT, YSEC)

- **Activity Chairs**: in charge of promoting specific outdoor activities and requesting funds from the board to purchase gear for those activities; activities that might deserve chairs at present include:

    - Hiking
    - Climbing and Mountaineering
    - Canoeing
    - Slacklining
    - Kayaking
    - Skiing
    - Mountain Biking
    - Surfing

IMPORTANT NOTES: With the exception of the Coordinators and the Treasurer, board positions should be open to graduate students as well as undergraduates. Officers can fill multiple positions, including serving as the liaisons of other groups to YO. For example, one person might be the YSEC liaison, the chair of mountain biking, the webmaster, and the publicist. The roles above should be considered explicit guidelines for the responsibilities of club officers, but in any given semester responsibilities could be shared by different officers or taken on by single officers. In the case of changing circumstances, the roles above should combined or reconfigured as seen fit by the YO board. For example, if people want to start slacklining, a new slacklining activity chair could be created.

Additional notes: Current rules about becoming a trip leader (i.e. the WFA requirement), having two leaders for every trip, and holding elections each semester for board positions, should stand. These and other rules could be added at any time to this plan. The 2000 YO constitution lists many of these rules. This plan might be used as the basis for a new constitution.

New Mission Statement

Name	Yale Outdoors (change registered name to this)
Brief description	Yale Outdoors is a year-round outing club committed to providing the Yale community with opportunities to explore the outdoors.
Mission	The mission of Yale Outdoors is to provide the Yale community with opportunities to explore the outdoors. In that interest, Yale Outdoors will facilitate outdoor trips and outdoor education; manage a fleet of outdoor gear; coordinate outdoor-related events on campus; coordinate activities with affiliated groups; and generally serve as the nexus of outdoor recreation for the Yale community.
Animating spirit	Yale Outdoors is committed to an inclusive culture that welcomes anyone interested in exploring the outdoors, regardless of prior experience. We believe that to feel at home in nature you must seek nature out; we are committed to doing so together. Together we have experienced exhilaration, gratitude, and good clean fun exploring the small chunk of North America that surrounds New Haven. It is one reason we feel at home at Yale.
Principal roles	1-Community network 2-Gear depot 3-Outings 3-Outdoor education

How This Will Work

A. Meetings

It makes sense to have two levels of meetings.

> **1. General Meeting:** *Once* each semester (preferably at the beginning), all board members should meet—*especially including liaisons of affiliated groups*—to discuss general plans for the semester, possibilities for collaboration, etc. This way everyone will stay on relatively the same page. If more collaboration is needed, General Meetings could be held more often.

2. Weekly Meeting: YO should continue its current Monday meetings to cover regular business. All board members do *not* need to come to these. For example, Winter School coordinators, the webmaster, alumni liaison, historian, and affiliated group liaisons might come infrequently.

B. Voting

1. Voting Officers: Not every position on the board needs to be a voting position. This might make it easier to reach a quorum. Alternatively, every officer could be given a vote in club decisions, but only if present. Or principal officers could be given veto power, or some other alternative to avoid slow decision-making. Not every issue needs to be decided by a vote.

2. Expenditures: On the other hand, with increased fundraising and requests for gear purchases coming from more people and serving more groups, expenditure of umbrella funds should be put to a board vote. This will mostly relate to gear. Do we buy a fleet of mountain bikes or a fleet of backcountry skis? These should not be decisions made by individual officers, unless explicitly given authority to do so in individual cases by the board. This will be essential in the long-term for holding ourselves accountable for how we spend donations to the club.

C. Affiliation

1. Each group affiliated with YO should have a short paragraph in the YO constitution defining the affiliation. For example, YMC will be more closely affiliated, sharing more activities and gear, than YSEC will be. The YO board and the affiliated group's board can agree on the language of the paragraph.

2. Additional collaborations, such as sharing FOOT's gear, can be agreed to in more detailed documents.

3. Affiliated groups' liaisons need to attend YO General Meetings.

4. Beyond these three stipulations, affiliations can be defined on an individual basis. For example, YMC might request the purchase of mountaineering equipment using umbrella funds and have a liaison attend most weekly meetings, while YSEC might only attend General Meetings and never request umbrella funds.

D. Autonomy

Until such a time as Yale creates an administrative department for outdoor life on campus, or redefines the status of student groups like Yale Outdoors, the way that groups currently register can stay the same. YO can remain a registered undergraduate group, without any additional recognition of its graduate and umbrella roles, and all affiliated groups can do the same. Affiliated groups might explicitly define what activities they will carry out independently of YO.

For example, YMC could continue to apply for UOFC funding each semester, meet on a regular basis, and facilitate activities specific to it. These might include managing the climbing team, developing its relationship with CT Rock Gym, holding climbing competitions, training YMC leaders in belay certification or top-rope anchoring, and holding events like Club Night.

E. Communication between groups

This is a key reason to restructure Yale Outdoors. Communication should occur at General Meetings where liaisons from all affiliated groups would have some face time. Any further communication could be handled by e-mail.

F. Examples

Buying new gear:

> A. The mountain biking chair wants YO to buy four new bikes at an approximate cost of $2,000. The board requests specific details about the bikes (to make sure they have been researched) and about whether the chair has obtained a club deal from any merchants. It consults first the treasurer about how much money the group has, and then the gear manager for a copy of the gear inventory. Discussion follows about funding priorities for the year, and a vote is either called right then or for a future meeting. If the board votes to purchase the bikes, then the chair and the treasurer sit down together to purchase the bikes online, or the chair sends an invoice to the treasurer, who then cuts a check. The gear manager updates the gear inventory accordingly.
>
> B. The backcountry skiing chair wants YO to buy a fleet of alpine touring ski equipment in anticipation of Winter School. The board requests specific details about the equipment and about whether a discount or sale has been found. It also needs to consider the other items that make skiing possible: poles, appropriate boots, bindings, skins, avalanche equipment, possibly a car rack. What can be rented, what cannot, and at what time of year are the best fleet deals available (for example, purchasing used skis from backcountry guides at the end of the season)? This type of purchase needs a more detailed plan before being put to a vote.

Coordinating a course:

> YO wants to offer a WFA course. It should contact its FOOT liaison to find out what FOOT's WFA needs are. If possible, FOOT's core head in charge of WFA and YO's events coordinator should work together to offer the course, advertising to both panlists.

Getting coverage in the YDN:

> YMC is planning its first expedition in forty years with YO support. YO's publicist (or whatever this role is called) should contact the news or features editors of the YDN suggesting coverage of the event and listing relevant contacts for use by the reporters.

Coordinating joint events:

> YO is co-sponsoring Earth Week events with YSEC and other affiliated groups. If the groups want to write joint or adjacent guest columns in the YDN, the YSEC liaison (or other liaisons) can discuss how to match tone and message. Following agreement about what events to hold, YO's publicist or one of the affiliated group's publicists can draw up a flyer for distribution across the panlists, on YaleStation.org, possibly in the YDN, and possibly for printing.

Planning trips:

> Two YO leaders want to plan an overnight hiking trip in the Green Mountains. At YO's weekly meeting (*not* necessarily at the General Meeting), the regular discussion can be held about planning trips for upcoming weekends. But rather than having trip leaders e-mail YO's coordinators their trip blurbs, trip leaders can post their trips themselves on the website. After a set deadline each week for inclusion in the YO newsletter, YO's coordinators can pull trip descriptions off the website for a very brief inclusion in the newsletter.

Starting new activities:

> A YO leader wants to offer more opportunities to kayak. He demonstrates interest (in whatever way) that other students are interested in kayaking. He presents some research about what needs to be done to offer more opportunities (where can classes be held? who will teach them? can equipment be rented or does it need to be bought? how much would a minimal fleet of kayaking equipment cost?). In other words, the onus is on the person interested in the activity to provide details about it. The board can then decide whether to create a new kayaking chair (sure, why not?), with a separate panlist (sure, why not?), and then how to fund it (to be considered seriously but cautiously). The webmaster adds the new chair and panlist to the website. The chair can write copy and links for inclusion on the website, including submitting calendar items of interest to the kayaking community.

Affiliating with new groups:

> The head of the Club Ski Team approaches YO about holding a joint avalanche course and using YO's skins for its own backcountry retreats. YO proposes creating a liaison position on the YO board for the ski team, drawing up a short paragraph to be added to the YO constitution describing a relationship agreed to by both parties. The webmaster adds the ski team in some way to the website.

Presence on Campus

Below are examples of the on-campus presence and activities of Yale Outdoors.

Panlists

The Yale Outdoors general panlist currently has 629 members who receive weekly club newsletters. The Yale Mountaineering Club general panlist currently has 338 members who receive weekly club newsletters.

The message below is an example of a YO newsletter:



Gmail

Spencer Gray <spencergray@gmail.com>

Yale Outdoors Newsletter

1 message

Raphael Magarik <raphael.magarik@yale.edu> **Wed, Mar 4, 2009 at 3:24 PM**
To: Raphael Magarik <raphael.magarik@yale.edu>

Dear outgoing folk,

No poetry at the bottom; some prose instead

Hope everyone has wonderful plans for break. Trips (more details will be coming around post-Break, thought I'd give you the layout):

Now, trips--last week there was a little mix-up between February and March:

Dayhike, Bear Mountain (Saturday, March 28th)
join us for a beautiful hike up connecticut's tallest peak (though that's not saying much ...)! All 2000 feet of it can be conquered on a 5 to 6 mile roundtrip hike on sunday, march 28. there will be great views and crisp weather. we will leave early that morning after breakfast and return in the afternoon. please email lisa.simon@yale.edu if interested. see you there!

Dayhike, Sunday March 29th
A day hike in Connecticut, leaving at 8:30 AM and back by mid-afternoon.
Contact Kate Lund or Amy Skerry for more info. Specify if you have a car.

Presidentials April 3-4th
More info on an overnight up to New Hampshire to come soon. We'll get to see a beautiful range of lovely mountains; conditions will be wet and snowy, but awesome. Email Raphael.magarik@yale.edu if interested

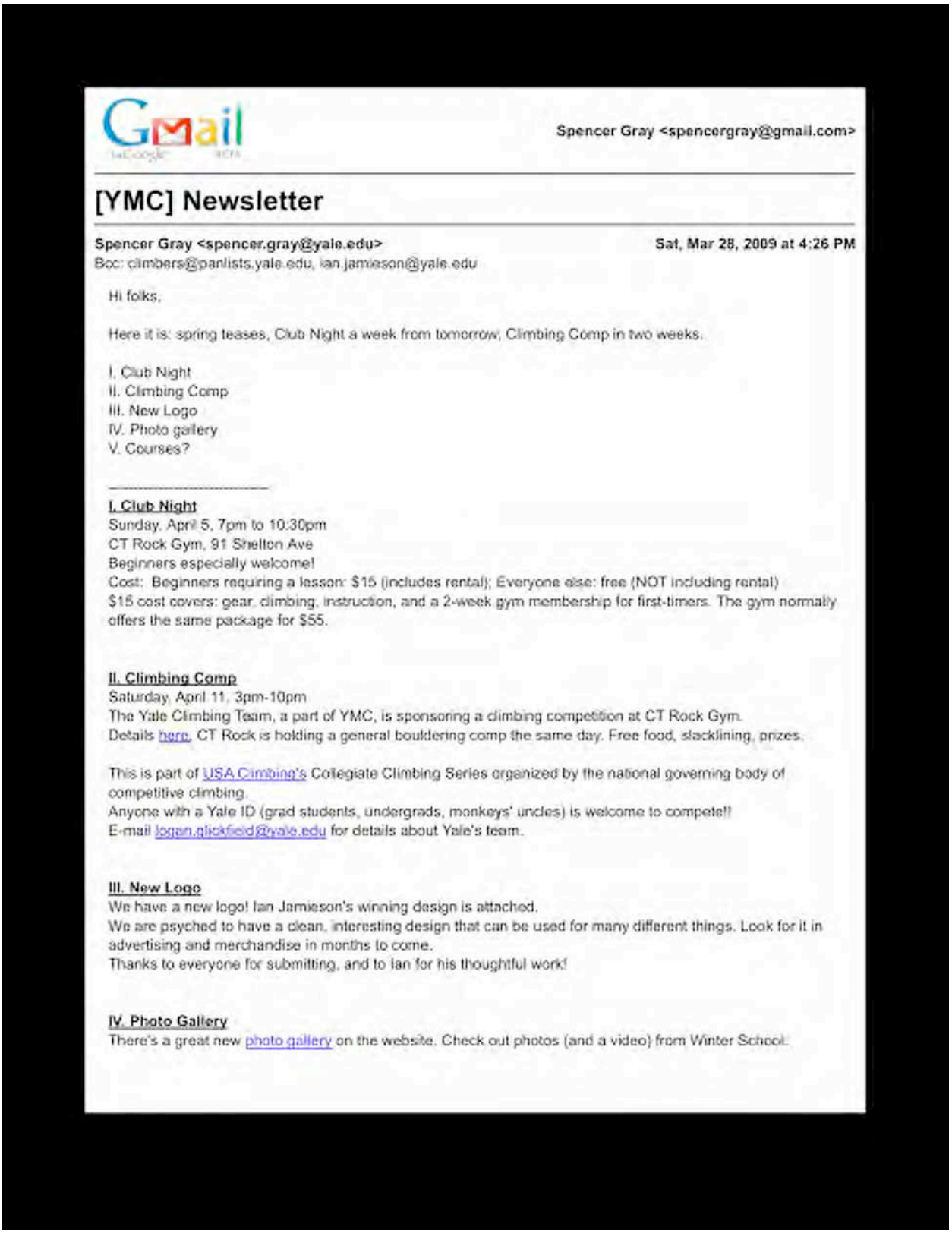
April 3-4 Backapcking Connecticut
Email lisa.simon@yale.edu or eli.bildner@yale.edu

April 11th Saturday Dayhike
Email Julian Malnak for more details (julian.malnak@yale.edu)

Thanks
Rafi Magarik

In this glare of brilliant emptiness, in this arid intensity of pure heat, in the heart of a weird solitude, great silence and grand desolution, all things recede to distances out of reach, reflecting light but impossible to touch, annihilating all thought and all that men have made to a spasm of whirling dust far out on the golden desert. -Edward Abbey

The message below is an example of a YMC newsletter:



Gmail

Spencer Gray <spencergray@gmail.com>

[YMC] Newsletter

Spencer Gray <spencer.gray@yale.edu> **Sat, Mar 28, 2009 at 4:26 PM**
Bcc: climbers@panlists.yale.edu, ian.jamieson@yale.edu

Hi folks,

Here it is: spring teases, Club Night a week from tomorrow, Climbing Comp in two weeks.

I. Club Night
II. Climbing Comp
III. New Logo
IV. Photo gallery
V. Courses?

I. Club Night
Sunday, April 5, 7pm to 10:30pm
CT Rock Gym, 91 Shelton Ave
Beginners especially welcome!
Cost: Beginners requiring a lesson: $15 (includes rental); Everyone else: free (NOT including rental)
$15 cost covers: gear, climbing, instruction, and a 2-week gym membership for first-timers. The gym normally offers the same package for $55.

II. Climbing Comp
Saturday, April 11, 3pm-10pm
The Yale Climbing Team, a part of YMC, is sponsoring a climbing competition at CT Rock Gym.
Details here. CT Rock is holding a general bouldering comp the same day. Free food, slacklining, prizes.

This is part of USA Climbing's Collegiate Climbing Series organized by the national governing body of competitive climbing.
Anyone with a Yale ID (grad students, undergrads, monkeys' uncles) is welcome to compete!!
E-mail logan.glickfield@yale.edu for details about Yale's team.

III. New Logo
We have a new logo! Ian Jamieson's winning design is attached.
We are psyched to have a clean, interesting design that can be used for many different things. Look for it in advertising and merchandise in months to come.
Thanks to everyone for submitting, and to Ian for his thoughtful work!

IV. Photo Gallery
There's a great new photo gallery on the website. Check out photos (and a video) from Winter School.

V. Courses?
We need your input about what courses to schedule with CT Rock Gym before the semester ends.
Potential courses: belay instruction (to teach basic safety skills to beginners), top-rope anchoring (super-useful for crags in CT), sport climbing.
E-mail emily.h.kruger@yale.edu to express interest.

Happy climbing,
Spencer

To remove yourself from this panlist go to http://panlists.yale.edu or e-mail me.

Yale Mountaineering Club Panlist
climbers@panlists.yale.edu

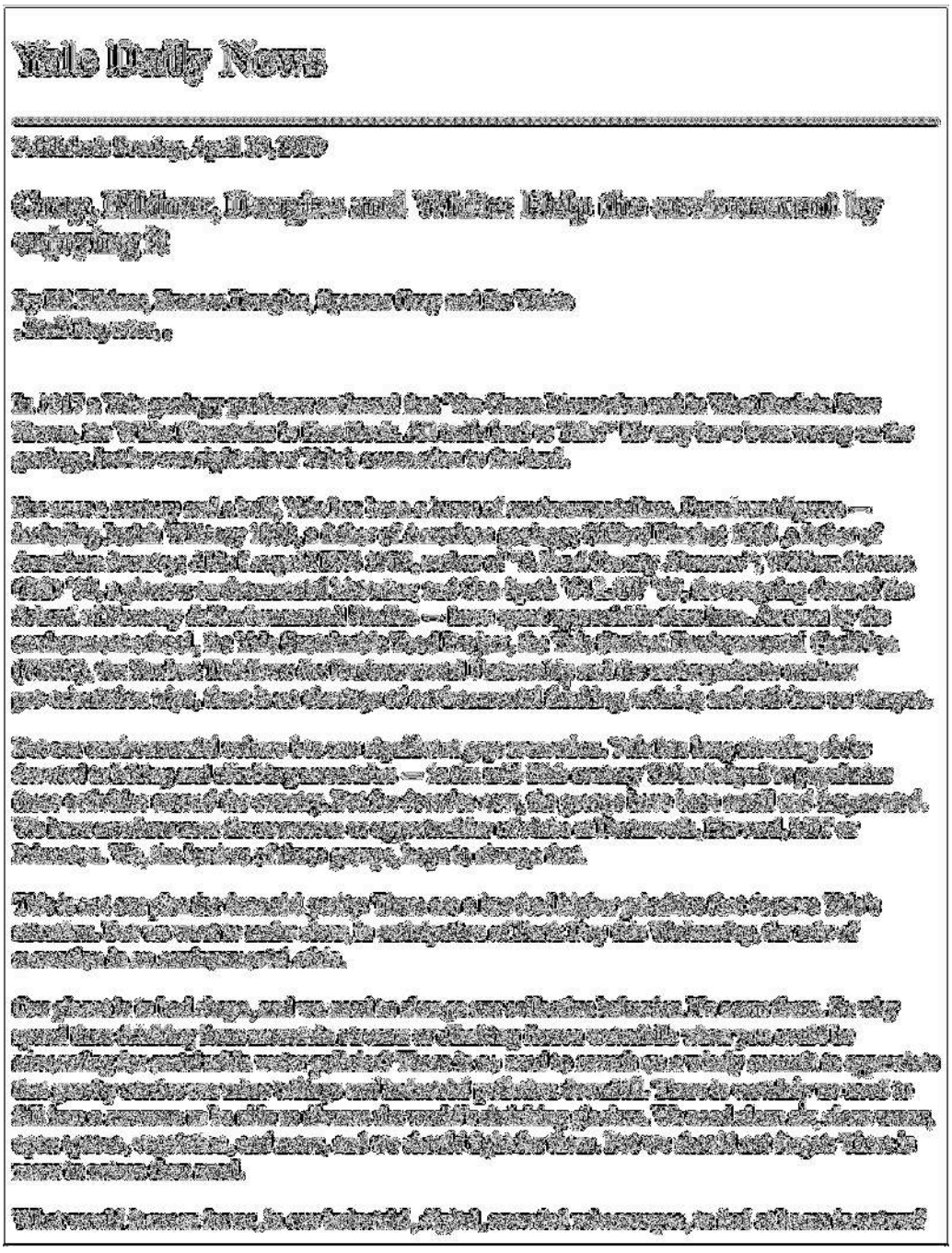


YMC logo.jpg
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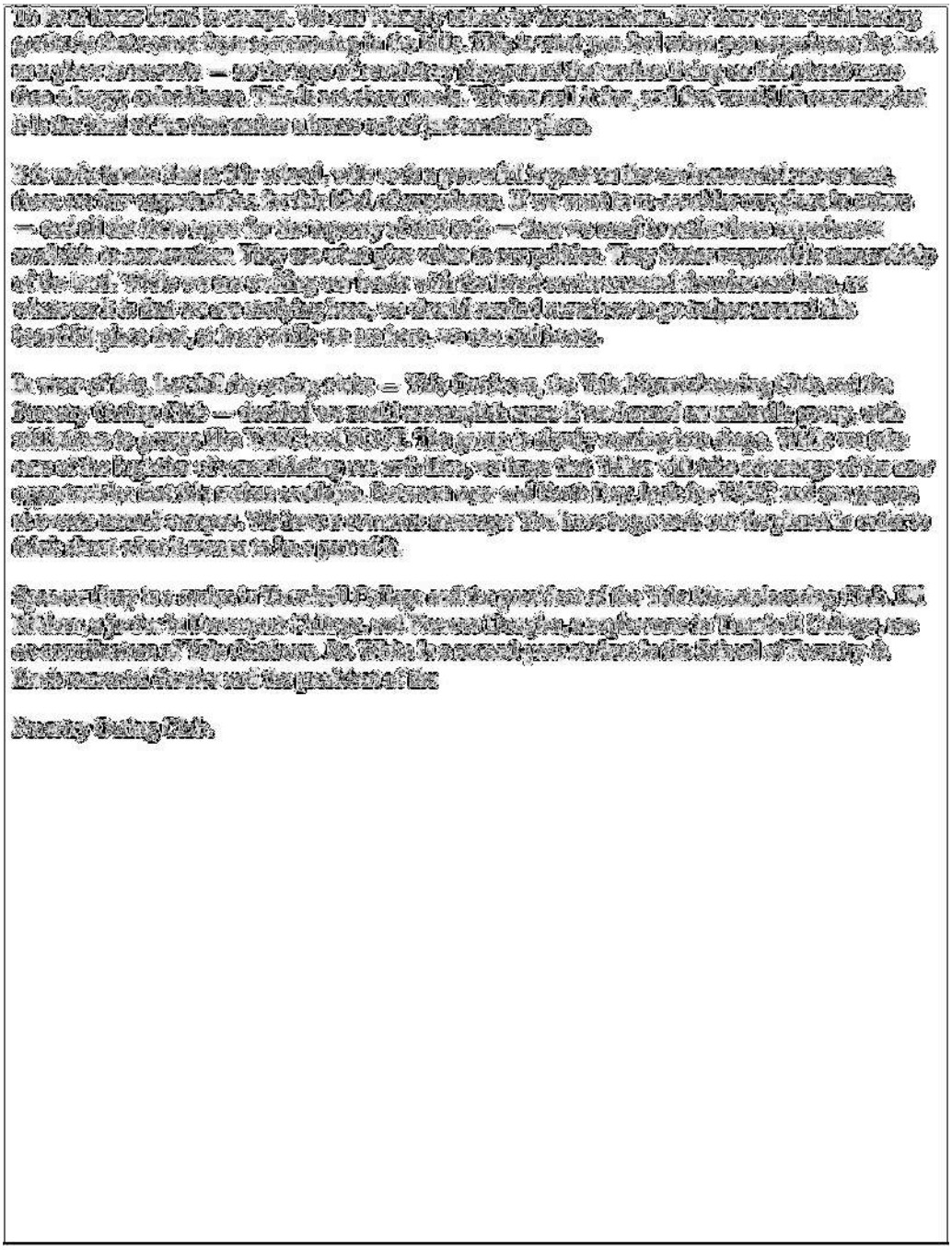


Earth Week 2009 Op-Ed

The Yale Daily News published a guest column by the leaders of the outing clubs in April 2009.



Yale Daily News



Wilderness First Aid courses

Sixteen Yalies earned their Wildernes First Aid certification in a course sponsored by Yale Outdoors February 28-March 1, 2009. Below is the financial correspondence between YO and the wilderness education company that provided the course.

PO Box 206185
New Haven, CT 06520

January 29, 2009

SOLO
c/o Jill MacMillan
P.O. Box 3150
Conway, NH 03818

Dear Ms. MacMillan:

Please find enclosed a $800 deposit check for SOLO's Wilderness First Aid course, sponsored by the undergraduate outing club at Yale University, Yale Outdoors, scheduled for February 28 - March 1, 2009.

Please direct any questions about payment or logistics to our Events Coordinator, Christopher Brown, christopher.brown@yale.edu or 713-539-3543.

Sincerely yours,

Spencer Gray
Treasurer, Yale Outdoors

Great Mountain Forest Cabin

For many years, Yale Outdoors has held retreats for club leaders at the Great Mountain Forest Wangum Brook Cabin in Canaan, Connecticut. YO pays for firewood each year at the cabin. Other Yale groups who make use of the cabin reimburse YO for the firewood.

Below is a short history of the cabin requested by YO from the forest manager in the fall of 2008.

Great Mountain Forest
Wangum Brook Cabin

The Wangum Brook Cabin was built in 1941 through the generosity of Edward C. (Ted) Childs. Located in the town of Canaan (Falls Village), the cabin and surrounding 6,041 acres are owned by the Great Mountain Forest Corporation (GMFC), a charitable, private operating foundation. The building is constructed of both American chestnut logs and red pine logs, the contractor who built the structure was C. H. Nickerson. The Nickerson family still owns and operates a construction business in nearby Burrville CT.

The Wangum Brook Cabin is used by many small groups, including Yale Outdoors and other individuals throughout the seasons. The former Yale Outing Club had in the past, used the cabin for an occasional retreat. Deer hunters that are given permits on the Great Mountain Forest often use the cabin as a base camp during the 3 week deer hunting season. Currently, a request in writing to the GMFC forest manager and/or forester is required at least 2 weeks prior to any stay.

The cabin is maintained at the expense of GMFC, there are plans to replace the roof and bridge in the near future. A new insulated metal stovepipe was added in November 2008 to allow the safe installation of a woodstove. Firewood must be purchased from GMFC to prevent the possible invasion of unwanted forest pests unknowingly brought in from outside sources. The cabin can safely and comfortably accommodate no more then 8 people. In the future there may be a modest charge for the use of the cabin to help offset maintenance costs.

Joel E. Bronson
Great Mountain Forest Corporation, Forest Manager
December 10, 2008

Medical Kits

To make sure its winter outing trips include adequate medical supplies, in the winter of 2009 Yale Outdoors solicited a medical kit list from an alpine expedition doctor who has been involved in the club. He suggested the following:

This assumes that the group is carrying adequate head torches, penknives with scissors and survival bags, etc.
Med-kits should be suitable for 5-6 on an overnight hike. For more consider doubling up on acetominophen and ibuprofen.

- Safety pins
- Ibuprofen – 200mg tablets, dose of 2, three times a day, 10 should be sufficient
- Acetaminophen – 500mg tablets, dose of 2, four times a day, 16 should be sufficient
- Consider loperamide – anti diarrhoea, again split a pack between kits 4mg is normal dose then maybe three more 2mg doses per day
- Antihistamine tablets – not sure of the tradenames over here. Don't need many, split a pack between the kits. Desloratidine is a good choice.
- Aspirin – one dose of 300mg in each kit (heart attacks are relatively common on hills and it makes a huge difference)
- Adhesive tape, ideally zinc oxide (white, strong, very sticky and non-stretchy) – good for blisters and kit repairs, at least two rolls per kit, it is so useful
- Blister pads, like these: http://www.drugstore.com/qxp86350_333181_sespider/2nd_skin/blister_pads.htm
- Non-adhesive bandages—larger the better (you can cut them up), get a few for each kit
- Adhesive plasters for simple cuts and grazes
- Antiseptic cream
- Chemical handwarmers

Trip Reports

Leaders of outing trips are requested to fill out trip reports when they return. Below are the trip report form and two examples of trips from the winter of 2008.

YALE OUTDOORS TRIP REPORT

Destination:
Date(s):
Weather Conditions:
Leaders:
Group Size:
Activity (i.e., hiking, canoeing):

Transportation:

Expenses:

Route Description/Trail Information:

Maps Used:

Highlights:

Difficulties encountered:

Other comments:

Feel free to attach trail or road maps, pictures, or other souvenirs of the trip!

YALE OUTDOORS TRIP REPORT [EXAMPLE]

Destination: Mt Monadnock

Date(s): Early February, 2008

Weather Conditions: Cloudy and winter storm in afternoon

Leaders: Judd Rosenblatt, Stephan Sanders

Group Size: 4

Activity (i.e., hiking, canoeing): snowshoeing

Transportation: 1 car; 2.5-3hrs

Expenses: gas; ~$10 parking fee

Route Description/Trail Information: Day snowshoe up and down two different trails to the top and back of Mt. Monadnock, the most prominent New England mountain south of the White Mountains and east of the Berkshires. Started out with a low cloud bank, ended with a full-out blizzard on the summit, and a quick descent.

Maps Used: internet topo print-out

Highlights: White-out conditions on summit; views before bumping our heads into the ceiling of the clouds; running and sliding descent on snowshoes; nearby brew pub for dinner

Difficulties encountered: White-out conditions on summit (GPS unit was helpful); ice-covered summit rocks, difficult for crampons on snowshoes to negotiate

Other comments:

Feel free to attach trail or road maps, pictures, or other souvenirs of the trip!



Judd Rosenblatt (’11), Margaret Middleton, and Stephan Sanders on summit of Mt. Monadnock



Descending Mt. Monadnock

YALE OUTDOORS TRIP REPORT [EXAMPLE]

Destination: Carter-Moriah Trail, White Mountains, New Hampshire
Date(s): Sat 2/23/08 – Sun 2/24/08
Weather Conditions: clearing up steadily after three inches new snow
Leaders: Spencer Gray, Eli Bildner
Group Size: 5
Activity (i.e., hiking, canoeing): snowshoeing

Transportation: 2 cars for shuttle route; 600 miles roundtrip

Expenses: about $170 for gas for 2 vehicles + $6 for parking fees

Route Description/Trail Information:

original plan : leave Gorham, NH on Carter-Moriah Trail after car camping at Barnes Field Friday night; snowshoe 7mi to Imp Campsite on Saturday; continue Sunday 11 miles on Carter-Moriah Trail to Carter Notch then down Nineteen Mile Brook Trail

positive: very flexible route RE start/end/exit points

modified plan after ugly winter storm Friday night: left 6am from New Haven; hiked 4.5mi up Stony Brook Trail to Imp Campsite (arrived at dark)—averaged 1mph hiking on firm snow (put on snowshoes for last mile); Sunday rose at 4am, snowshoeing by 5am; because of loose snow and a very steep trail grade up North Carter Mountain, cut day short, completing 6.5mi down North Carter Trail and Imp Trail; returned to New Haven about 10:30pm

Maps Used: Map Adventures White Mountains waterproof map

Highlights: counting mileage by the number of Dunkin' Donuts passed on highway; navigating by moonlight Sunday morning; watching the sunrise from the trail; bluebird day Sunday: good views of the Presidential Range, into Canada, Maine, and even to the Atlantic; Moat Mountain Brewpub in North Conway; three hungry spookily friendly gray jays on Imp Trail

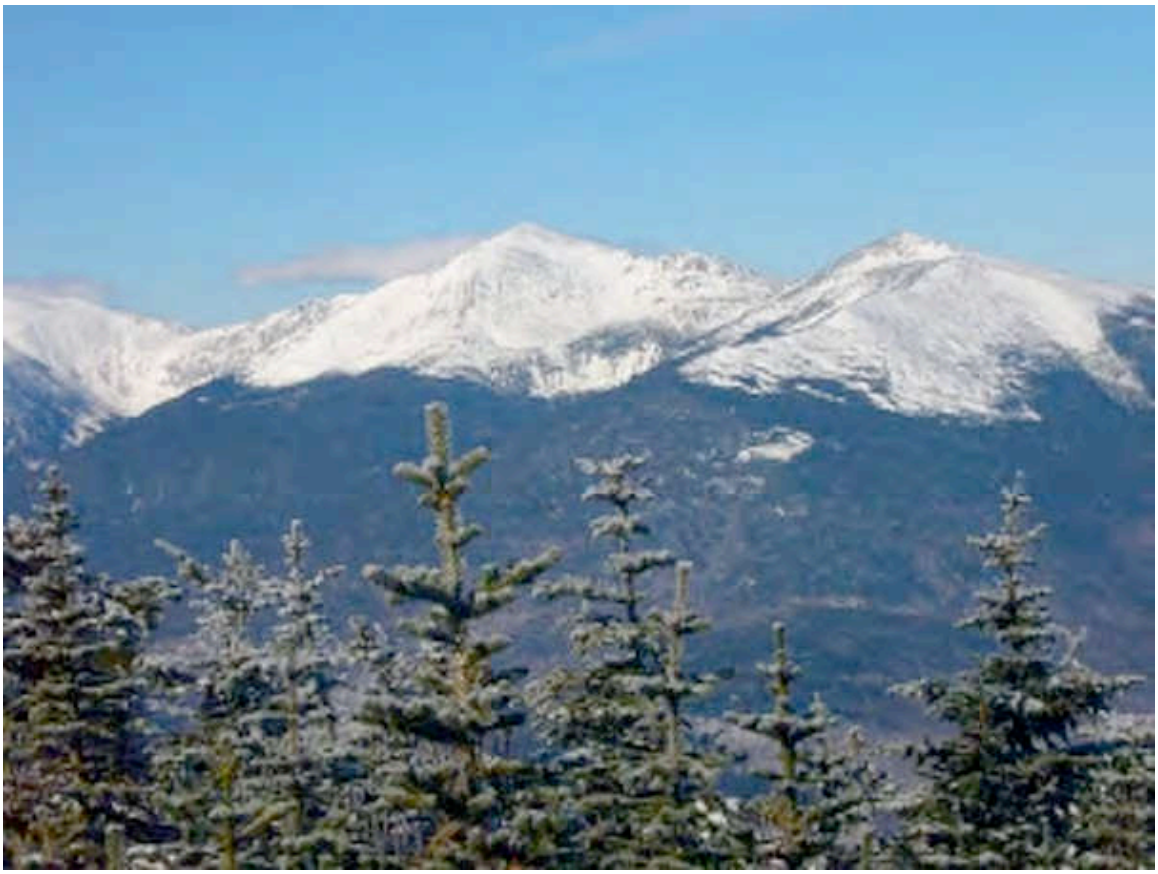
Difficulties encountered: taking turns satisfying Pat the Pot Fiend's insatiable thirst for receptive ears at Imp Campsite—that guy could talk, and also smoke lots of pot; navigation, especially in dark: beware of trail in winter: snowpack covers up obvious route and you will be walking through many branches that would be overhead in the summer; super-steep trail up North Carter Mountain from the north, especially with snow collapsing underneath; the second batch of Eli's pasta extravaganza: syrup, soy sauce, and peanut butter do go well together, but the extra cup of garlic powder doesn't; Stephan's Britishisms sometimes impeded communication: beware of Brits

Other comments: Imp Campsite has a shelter, so is great as a place to start testing out winter conditions; this trail route is also very flexible; when the Presidentials get awful weather, Carter-Moriah is often sheltered from it; snowshoes were necessary on the trail; if conditions were very icy, crampons would probably have been necessary

Feel free to attach trail or road maps, pictures, or other souvenirs of the trip!



Eli Bildner (’10) experimenting with a giant foodstuff, courtesy Morse Dining Hall.



View of Presidential Range from Carter-Moriah Range.



Eli Bildner (’10), Spencer Gray (’09), Andrew Wiedemann (’11), and Sarah Hill (’11) on summit of North Carter Mtn.

Gear Rental

Yale Outdoors and Yale Mountaineering Club currently have the following gear available for rental (this list is available at yalemountaineering.org/rentalgear.aspx):

Items with a blue background are restricted items. Renters must get permission from the gear manager to rent them.

*The list below only shows items available as of early March 2009.

Item	Deposit	Daily Rental
Camping		
Backpacking 3-season tent	$250	$5
Backpacking 4-season tent	$450	$7
3-season sleeping bag (15° - 30°F) (inc. stuff sack)	$150	$3
Winter sleeping bag (-30° - 0°F) (inc. stuff sack)	$250	$5
Foam pad	$25	$1
Stove (inc. fuel)	$75	$3
Cooking pot	$30	$1
Climbing		
Climbing helmet	$60	$1
Climbing harness (includes ATC+carabiner)	$65	$2
ATC and carabiner	$25	$1
Technical ice climbing axe	$250	$5
Hiking		
Backpack	$200	$4
Winter trekking boots (Mickey Mouse)	$75	$3
Mountaineering boots (Mad Rock)	$190	$4
Mountaineering crampons	$125	$3
In-step crampons	$45	$2
Crampon bag	$25	$1
Alpine ice axe	$100	$2
Snowshoes	$175	$4
Trekking poles (per pair)	$65	$2
Wag bag	NA	$3

YO and YMC have developed the following rental policies to make renters accountable for equipment and to maintain equipment through the years.

Procedures

Gear can be rented and returned during Office Hours, which during Winter School are Mondays 6-7pm and Thursdays 9pm-late. You must be a Yale outing club member (YO, YMC, or Forestry Outing) to rent gear; you can join when you make your first rental. You are allowed to rent gear for up to two people.

Renting: You need to leave a deposit check when you rent the gear. This is to cover the cost of replacing gear that is lost or damaged. See the rental gear list for details. We will destroy your deposit check once you return the gear safely.

Returning: Gear must be returned at Office Hours within 1 week of the rental date. To rent for longer you must make special arrangements with the gear staff.

Rental fees are collected when the gear is returned. While the deposit must be a check, fees can be paid by cash (exact change only), check, or debit/credit card. Fees are based on the number of days the gear was actually used (not the length of rental). See the rental gear list for the daily fees.

Restricted Gear

Most Yale outing club gear can be rented by all club members. However, some technical items, such as technical ice tools and mountaineering tents, require the permission of gear manager before they can be rented. See the Officers page for the manager's e-mail.

Late Fees

Rentals not returned within a week—unless special arrangements are made—are considered late. We assess late fines at the rate of one day's rental for every office hour the gear is overdue. If gear (or payment) is very late, we will send you a reminder email. In the worst case, we reserve the right to cover the cost of replacing gear using your deposit check.

Damage to Gear

Members renting gear are responsible for any loss, theft, breakage or other damage to equipment. You should inspect gear before rental so that you are not charged for existing damage. We will do our best to keep track of such damage so that no one is caught by surprise. Gear must be returned clean and dry. We do not accept returned gear that is dirty or wet.

All gear will be inspected upon return. Members returning damaged gear will be charged for the repair and/or replacement cost, as determined by the gear manager.

Winter School

A few special rental policies for when Winter School is in session (in February).

- Winter School trip participants have priority over other members when renting gear.
- Rentals cannot be extended beyond 1 week.

- Members may rent group gear when a trip leader requests that they do so. This may include gear normally reserved for leaders of official trips, such as first aid kits and emergency tents. Members who rent these group items are responsible for them and must leave a deposit for them, but they will not be charged rental fees.

Other Information

This rental system, based on the model of the MIT Outing Club, functions by requiring single individuals to take personal responsibility for rentals.

Gear is available to Yale outing club members on a first-come basis. We do not accept reservations, from groups or from individuals. Check out gear early rather than late in the week to make sure you have what you need for your trip.

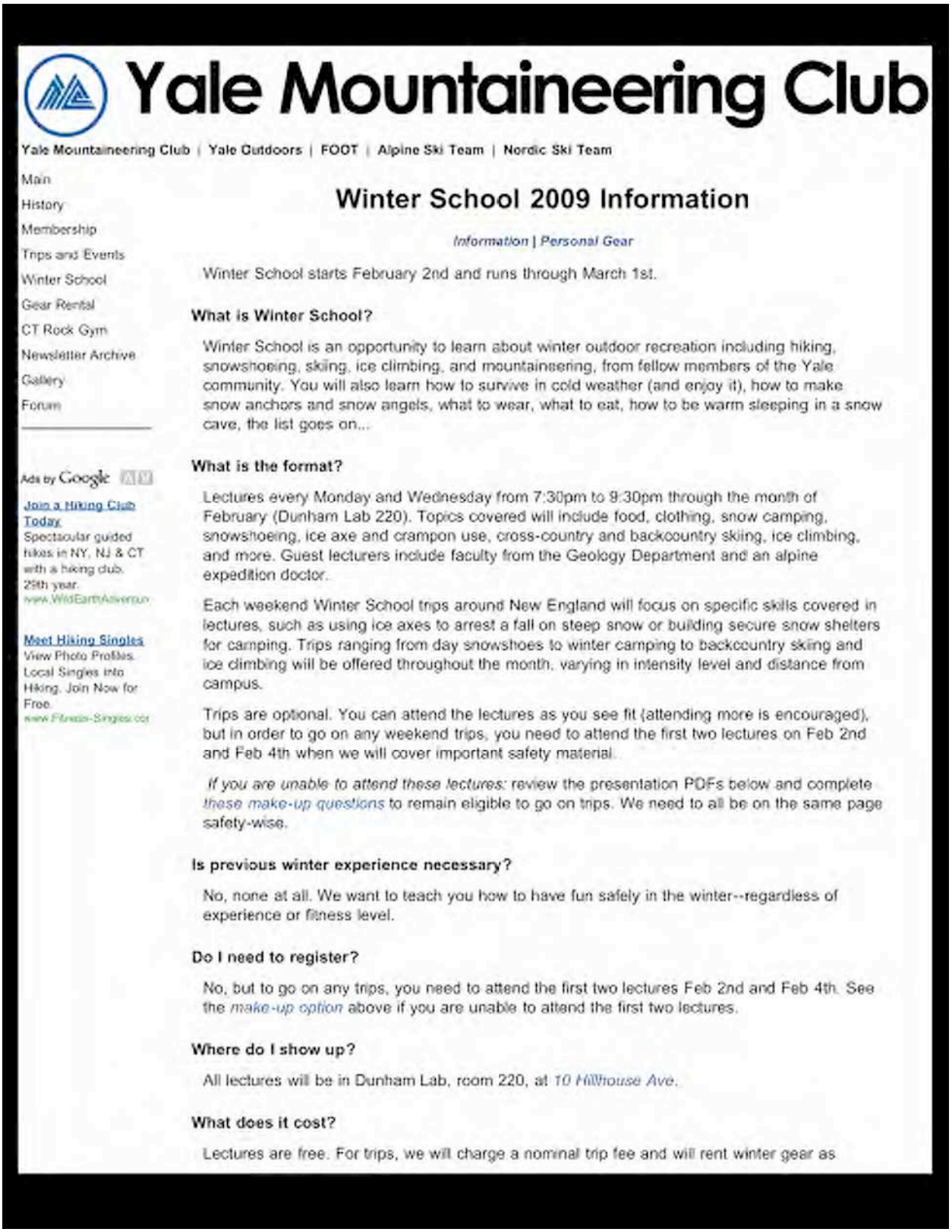
Disclaimer

It is the member's responsibility, not the clubs', to understand how to use rented gear properly, as well as to understand the limitations of the gear. You should only rent gear that you are qualified to use. Outdoor recreation involves an inherent degree of risk. Renters should be aware that gear may fail, even when used properly. It is the individual's responsibility to be safe and to use proper judgment with rental gear. Please be safe.

Winter School

The documents below pertain to Yale's first annual Winter School, a month-long program run jointly by Yale Outdoors, Yale Mountaineering Club, and Forestry Outing Club, in February 2009.

The following information is from the YMC website.
(http://yalemountaineering.org/winterschool.aspx)
The hyperlinks under the lecture topics link to 30 winter recreation presentations.



Yale Mountaineering Club

Yale Mountaineering Club | Yale Outdoors | FOOT | Alpine Ski Team | Nordic Ski Team

Main
History
Membership
Trips and Events
Winter School
Gear Rental
CT Rock Gym
Newsletter Archive
Gallery
Forum

Ads by Google

Join a Hiking Club Today
Spectacular guided hikes in NY, NJ & CT with a hiking club. 25th year.
www.WildEarthAdventure

Meet Hiking Singles
View Photo Profiles. Local Singles into Hiking. Join Now for Free.
www.Fitness-Singles.com

Winter School 2009 Information

Information | *Personal Gear*

Winter School starts February 2nd and runs through March 1st.

What is Winter School?

Winter School is an opportunity to learn about winter outdoor recreation including hiking, snowshoeing, skiing, ice climbing, and mountaineering, from fellow members of the Yale community. You will also learn how to survive in cold weather (and enjoy it), how to make snow anchors and snow angels, what to wear, what to eat, how to be warm sleeping in a snow cave, the list goes on...

What is the format?

Lectures every Monday and Wednesday from 7:30pm to 9:30pm through the month of February (Dunham Lab 220). Topics covered will include food, clothing, snow camping, snowshoeing, ice axe and crampon use, cross-country and backcountry skiing, ice climbing, and more. Guest lecturers include faculty from the Geology Department and an alpine expedition doctor.

Each weekend Winter School trips around New England will focus on specific skills covered in lectures, such as using ice axes to arrest a fall on steep snow or building secure snow shelters for camping. Trips ranging from day snowshoes to winter camping to backcountry skiing and ice climbing will be offered throughout the month, varying in intensity level and distance from campus.

Trips are optional. You can attend the lectures as you see fit (attending more is encouraged), but in order to go on any weekend trips, you need to attend the first two lectures on Feb 2nd and Feb 4th when we will cover important safety material.

If you are unable to attend these lectures: review the presentation PDFs below and complete *these make-up questions* to remain eligible to go on trips. We need to all be on the same page safety-wise.

Is previous winter experience necessary?

No, none at all. We want to teach you how to have fun safely in the winter--regardless of experience or fitness level.

Do I need to register?

No, but to go on any trips, you need to attend the first two lectures Feb 2nd and Feb 4th. See the *make-up option* above if you are unable to attend the first two lectures.

Where do I show up?

All lectures will be in Dunham Lab, room 220, at *10 Hillhouse Ave.*

What does it cost?

Lectures are free. For trips, we will charge a nominal trip fee and will rent winter gear as

needed. You will also need to *join the outing clubs* ($10/semester) to go on any trips. Remember to bring your checkbook at that time. You will need at least one check for a deposit each time you rent gear, and then when you return gear you can pay rental fees by cash, check, or card. Gas will be split by trip participants.

What do I need if I want to go on trips?

You can rent most technical gear from the outing clubs, but you will need your own winter clothing. And you will need a few pieces of gear: A compass, whistle, flashlight (headlamp preferred), and water bottles (at least 2 liters worth). See a full list of clothing and gear *here*.

Sign up for trips *here*.

What are the lecture topics?

Feb 2: Essential Skills

- *Introduction*
- *Mountain weather* (*Additional Information*)
- *Food and water*
- *Clothing* and *basic gear*
- *Winter driving*
- *Backpack fitting*
- *Cheap gear sources*

Feb 4: Basic Winter Travel

- *Peeing in the woods/hygiene*
- *Winter hiking basics*
- *Ice axes and crampons*
- *Navigation*
- *Winter School trip policies*

Feb 9: Backcountry Safety and Climbing

- *Trip planning*
- *Cold-weather health and injuries*
- *Ice climbing*

Feb 11: Multi-Day Trips

- *Overnight camping basics*
- *Camping food and stoves*
- *Snow shelters and tents*
- *Safety and risk*

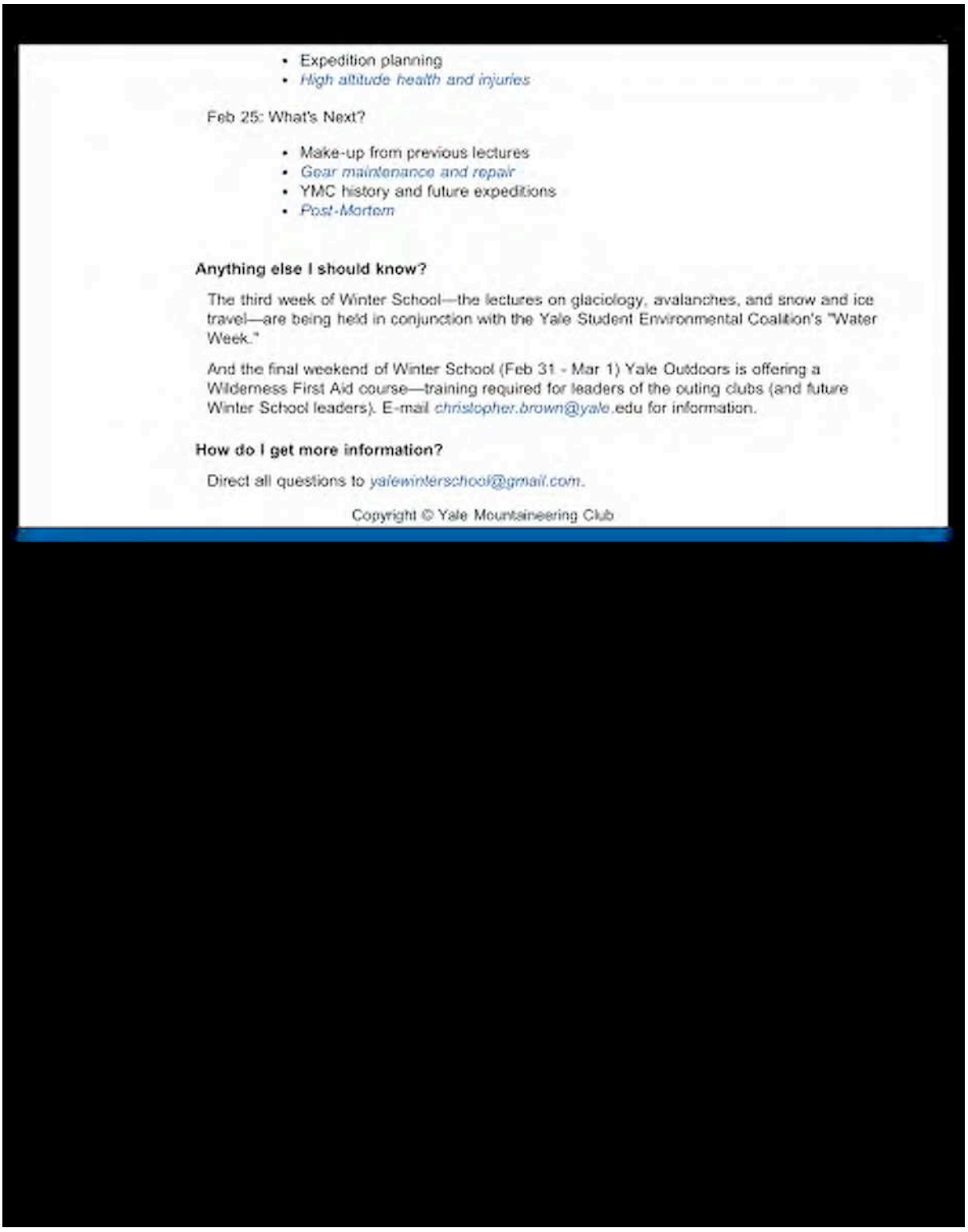
Feb 16: Advanced Winter Travel

- *Avalanches (part I)*
- *Advanced snow travel*
- *Glacier travel*

Feb 18: Skiing and Glaciers

- *Glaciology*
- *Cross-country skiing*
- *Backcountry skiing*

Feb 23: Expeditions



The following prospectus was submitted to the Yale administration for funding purposes in December 2008. It outlines the purpose and full details of Winter School. It also contains the liability waiver, medical information form, and gear inventories of YO and YMC.

Yale Winter School 2009

Prospectus

December 26, 2008

Sponsored by:
Yale Outdoors, Yale Mountaineering Club, and Forestry Outing Club

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    F. YO Gear Inventory

I. Executive Summary

Yale Winter School is an introduction to wilderness winter recreation. The school is designed to take advantage of New Haven's proximity to places like the Adirondacks, Catskills, and White Mountains and provide Yale students with hands-on outdoor winter recreation experience. During the month of February, lectures two nights a week will prepare students for winter day trips, winter camping, and winter mountaineering. Topics covered at lectures will include food, clothing, snow camping, snowshoeing, ice travel, cross-country and backcountry skiing, ice climbing, and more. All levels of experience are welcome.

The emphasis of Winter School will be on teaching safe enjoyment of the outdoors in the winter. Experienced students will teach lectures and lead trips. Lectures will focus on safety, developing skills, and making careful decisions when planning and executing winter trips. Each trip will include several learning objectives, such as using ice axes to arrest a fall on a mountain slope or building secure snow shelters for camping. As trips become progressively more advanced, participants will be required to have attended preceding lectures and participated in previous introductory trips.

In order to launch this initiative, we are seeking initial funding of $6,000 to $18,000 to cover equipment costs for the first year of Winter School. *See below: Section IX, Funding Request.*

II. Background

Aside from occasional snowshoeing trips, the undergraduate outing clubs at Yale have largely gone dormant during the winter months. We, the leaders of these groups, have identified several causes:

1. Winter recreation requires more sophisticated skills and involves a higher general level of risk than activities during the rest of the year.
2. Students are generally not aware of winter wilderness opportunities in New England.
3. Students do not have the skills necessary for winter recreation.
4. Students do not have the equipment necessary for winter recreation.

Yet there are members of the Yale outdoor community who do engage in all manner of winter recreation, including snow camping, cross-country skiing, backcountry skiing, and ice climbing. Until now they have not had an adequate forum to share these skills. As a result, they have pursued these activities privately, while others must seek private training or resign themselves to staying inside during the winter. Yalies are missing out on the opportunity to share their knowledge and to extend their passion for wilderness travel into the winter. They are missing the physical and mental benefits of communing with the snowy land beyond New Haven's gray winter streets.

This first annual "Winter School" is a joint effort between undergraduate and graduate outdoor recreationists to improve this situation. By leveraging the resources (material, intellectual, and practical) of our outing clubs, more Yale students can be introduced to the joy of winter recreation. Among us, we have the relevant skills to make this introduction informative and safe; furthermore, we are committed to sharing the work. Finally, Winter School returns Yale to its long tradition of winter mountaineering: Yale Mountaineering Club members were pioneers of winter recreation in the Northeast from the 1920s through the 1970s.

Winter recreation education became a fixture on the calendar of outing clubs in the Northeast in the 1950s as more people starting skiing and snowshoeing into the backcountry. The Massachusetts Institute of Technology Outing Club (MITOC) initiated a "Winter School" in the early 1960s as part of this general trend. It has become the principal education component of MITOC's program, and the principal source of new leaders for that club. MITOC's Winter School regularly attracts 100 participants. We have adopted their Winter School as our model, and we hope our Winter School will achieve similar success. We have corresponded with the coordinators at MITOC about organizing this type of program.

III. Calendar

February 2 to March 1, 2009

- Lectures: Monday and Wednesdays 7:30pm-9:30pm
- Trips: day trips and overnight trips each weekend

IV. Lectures

Twice a week at night, Winter School leaders will lecture on a variety of topics, beginning with the very basics of winter recreation: what clothing to wear, how the weather behaves in the mountains, how to stay hydrated, etc. Lectures will become progressively more advanced throughout the month. Guest lecturers with expertise in their field will include Ron Smith (Department of Geology) on mountain weather, Keith Laskowski (Department of Geology) on glaciology, and Stephan Sanders (Child Study Center) on high altitude medicine. In addition, Winter School will collaborate with the Yale Student Environmental Coalition (YSEC) during the third week of February for the YSEC-sponsored "Water Week." A lecture on glaciology and mountain snowpack dovetails with the environmental concerns of Water Week.

A tentative schedule of topics is posted below. Each topic title corresponds to a PowerPoint presentation that a different leader will deliver.

Tentative Schedule

Lecture	**Topics covered**
Lecture 1: Intro/Essential Skills	Winter School intro Mountain weather Food and water Clothing Peeing (etc.) in the woods Gear for dayhikes Cheap gear sources
Lecture 2: Winter travel/Basic technical gear	Winter driving Winter hiking basics (below treeline: crampons but no axe, no ropes) Self-arrest (ice axe use) Snowshoes Backpacks (fitting, loading, etc) Navigation Yale Winter School trip policies
Lecture 3: Backcountry safety	Trip planning Safety and Risk Survival techniques Cold-weather health and injuries Avalanches
Lecture 4: Multi-day trips	Overnight basics Sleeping Camping food Stoves

	Snow shelters (quinzees, igloos, snow caves) and winter tents
Lecture 5: Advanced winter travel	Advanced snow travel (rope teams, snow protection) Ice climbing (including ice protection) [Make-up topic if needed]
Lecture 6: Glaciers and skiing	Glaciology Glacier travel Cross-country skiing Backcountry skiing
Lecture 7: Expeditions	Expedition planning (logistics, sleds, etc.) High altitude health and injuries [Maybe avalanches more in-depth]
Lecture 8: Finishing up	YMC history Gear maintenance/repair What next [Make-up topic if needed]

V. Trips

Trips scheduled for each of the four weekends of Winter School will focus on applying lessons that were covered in lecture. These trips will become progressively more challenging over the course of the school, as lectures delve into more sophisticated content: from easy winter day hikes to overnight trips to ice climbing and skiing trips. Trips will depend on the interest of participants, the availability of vehicles, and weather conditions. To date, a half dozen vehicles have been committed for trips.

Locations will vary depending on the activity. Ice climbing can be found around Connecticut and in southern New York. Snowshoeing is usually pursued further north. Several sites in southern New Hampshire and Vermont that are close enough for day trips from New Haven produce challenging winter weather conditions. Overnight traverses can be found in northern New Hampshire, Vermont, and New York.

Each trip will be led by two leaders with relevant experience. Participants will need to attend relevant preceding lectures or demonstrate sufficient experience. They can sign up for trips online in late January and in February. Winter School trips will follow a strict protocol of waiver forms, medical forms, and participant preparation. *See below: Section VIIa, Participant Preparation and Section VIII, Safety*.

VI. Leadership

The organizers of Winter School are all leaders of outing clubs on campus. We have taken courses in mountaineering, avalanche safety, wilderness first aid and first responding, emergency medical techniques, among others. We have a variety of experience in the wilderness in the winter. The following groups are represented: Yale Outdoors (YO), Yale Mountaineering Club (YMC), Forestry Outing Club (FOC), and the Nordic Ski Team (NST).

Winter School leaders can be contacted at yalewinterschool@gmail.com or winterschoolplanning@panlists.yale.edu.

In alphabetical order, the principal organizers are:

Eli Bildner DC '10
Co-Coordinator, YO
Claire Bucholz SM '09
Education Coordinator, YMC; Former Co-Coordinator, YO
Frances Douglas TC '11
Co-Coordinator, YO
Logan Glickfield BR '10
Treasurer, YMC
Spencer Gray TC '09
President, YMC; Treasurer, YO
Raiden Hasegawa BR '10
Gear Manager, YMC
Sarah Hill BR '11
Manager, NST
Jonathan Kreiss-Tomkins BR '12
Expedition Coordinator, YMC
Emily Kruger BR '11
Trips Coordinator, YMC
Boris Lukanov EAS '12
Education Coordinator, FOC
Raphael Magarik MC '10
Co-Coordinator, YO
Judd Rosenblatt BK '11
Gear Manager, YO
Erin Savage FES '10
Vice President, FOC
Bo White FES '09
President, FOC
Andrew Wiedemann SM '11
Webmaster, YO

Professional Consultation:
Connecticut Rock Gym (www.ctrockgym.com) of New Haven is providing *pro bono* consultation to the outing clubs for the most economical sources of equipment, ideas about trip locations, and general guidance about safety and logistics. Nate McKenzie, co-owner of the

facility and a certified American Mountain Guide Association climbing guide, is the principal contact.

VII. Participation

Winter School is open to all members of the Yale community. Participation in trips is NOT required.

Communication with participants occurs via a Pantheon panlist: winterschoolers@panlists.yale.edu.
As of mid-December, 2008, this panlist numbered 98 people, many of whom signed up at an information session in early December.

Parties interested in trips have been directed to examine information below about preparation and costs.

A. Preparation

Gear participants must personally own:

- Compass
- Whistle
- Flashlight (headlamp preferred)
- Water bottles (at least 2 1-liter bottles)

Clothing participants must personally own:

* Body:
  - Non-cotton undershirt (wicking)
  - Fleece/wool warming layer (warming)
  - Water/wind-resistant shell (water/windproofing)
* Legs:
  - Non-cotton long underwear (wicking)
  - Fleece/wool pants/shell (warm, wind/water-resistant top layer - insulation and shell can be combined or separate)
* Hands:
  - Liner gloves - non-cotton (wicking)
  - Insulating gloves or mittens (warming, two pair recommended)
  - Overmitts - wind/water-resistant - can be combined with insulating gloves (water/windproofing)
* Face/Head:
  - Warm hat
  - Face mask or balaclava
  - Goggles/Sun glasses
* Feet:
  - Liner socks - non-cotton (wicking)
  - Warm socks - wool, fleece, or other synthetic insulating material (for warming)
  - Gaiters (duct tape can be a great substitute)

*Boots (mountaineering or winter hiking: we recommend participants buy their own pair of boots this year; Winter School will eventually stock these, but this year it will be difficult to acquire enough sizes)

Other personal gear (participants might want to own):

* Trail food
* Map(s)
* Space blanket (a good idea)
* Spare headlamp batteries
* Pocket knife
* Bandana
* Camera
* Chemical hand-warmers & toe-warmers
* First aid kit
* Tissues/TP
* Book: *Mountaineering: The Freedom of the Hills*

Gear that (funding pending) can be rented from Yale Outdoors:

* Backpack
* Boots
* Crampons
* Snowshoes
* Ice axe
* Tent
* Stove
* Other technical gear

Gear that can (likely) be rented before trips at outdoor stores:

* Skis & poles
* Technical boots
* Other multi-size technical items

Stores

Local

* Trailblazer – with exception of a few sales, generally expensive and a poor selection
* Ascent – at Connecticut Rock Gym; growing technical mountaineering selection

Regional

* EMS - look in the back corner of the store, where they have the returns. You can often find great deals. Locations: Fairfield, West Hartford, Manchester, Danbury
* REI – West Hartford
* Cabela's – East Hartford

* North Cove Outfitters – Old Saybrook

Less technical stores

Lots of stores that don't carry expensive name brand clothing have clothing that can be perfectly useful for Winter School. Apply what you've learned to select layering material. Long underwear often makes wonderful layers.

* Eddie Bauer outlets (Westbrook, Danbury)
* Sears
* Target
* K-Mart
* Wal-Mart

Thrift

* Salvation Army
* Goodwill

Good values online

* http://sierratradingpost.com
* http://www.campmor.com
* http://www.rei-outlet.com
* http://www.backcountryoutlet.com
* http://www.mec.ca (note prices in CDN$)

B. Costs

All lectures are free.

Participating in trips requires:

An outing club membership:	$10
Trip fee:	$5
Gas money:	dependent on price and distance
Gear rental fees:	minimal

Total: Expect to pay $30-40 for most trips; overnighters and more technical trips will cost more.

Rental: The clubs provide gear at minimal rental fees in order to cover the costs of maintenance and replacement, as well as to buy new gear. These prices are much lower than retail rental stores. We require a deposit for the approximate value of each item in case of loss or damage. *See below: Section X, Appendix A: Gear Rental Prices*.

VIII. Safety

This program does not constitute a formal education in winter recreation. It does not certify participants in winter recreation, nor does it replace a full certification course. It is an informal program based on sharing skills among a campus community. Participation is voluntary.

A safety committee of Winter School organizers determines the qualifications of leaders, based on demonstrated experience and training. Safety protocol for leadership is based on the protocol of Yale Outdoors, which requires two qualified leaders per outing and that leaders have taken basic wilderness first aid courses. In addition, participants must sign medical information forms and waivers acknowledging awareness of the risks involved in outdoor recreation. Finally, trip leaders will meet with potential participants before each trip and have final discretion about allowing them to participate. Participants need to have attended relevant lectures during the week or have demonstrated experience on similar outings.

See below: Section X, Appendix B: Leader Resumes, Appendix C: Participant Waiver Form, and Appendix D: Health History Form.

IX. Funding Request

The principal expense of Winter School is group gear.

We have contacted ski resorts, outdoor gear retailers, and outdoor gear manufacturers about group discounts and the possibility of donations to Yale Winter School.

Yale Outdoors expects to have $10,000 in anonymous donations by February as a discretionary fund to buy essential gear. The donors' preferred use of this money is for the creation of an umbrella outdoor recreation organization at Yale. Because Winter School is intended as the educational centerpiece of this planned organization, we have some discretion about using funds to purchase equipment. But we need to secure primary funds elsewhere.

The trips described above are contingent on the outing clubs acquiring the necessary gear to furnish participants. Pooled together, the groups do not currently have the resources to equip students for winter travel. In general the items in the current inventories are appropriate for three-season hiking: tents, summer sleeping bags, sleeping pads, and stoves. In addition, YO owns some snowshoes and ice axes, and YMC owns harnesses and several ropes appropriate for snow travel. *See below: Section X, Appendix E: YMC Gear Inventory and Appendix F: YO Gear Inventory.*

The activities outlined in the lecture schedule above can be divided into four categories of equipment: winter hiking, winter camping, ice climbing, and skiing. Within these categories is essential gear for the respective activities:

Winter Hiking:

Mountaineering boots, crampons, crampon bags, mountaineering axes, snowshoes, hiking poles, snow flukes, harnesses, dry-treated ropes

Winter Camping:
Four-season tents, winter sleeping bags, pads, stoves, flashlights, pots, shovels, snow saws, lanterns
Ice Climbing:
Technical axes, technical crampons, plastic boots
Skiing:
Touring skis, touring boots, backcountry skis, backcountry boots, ski poles, car rack, ski skins, avalanche beacons, avalanche probes

Winter School's first purchasing priority this year is "one-size-fits-all" items such as sleeping bags and crampons. The second priority is items essential for basic winter travel such as hiking poles and four-season tents. The third priority is more technical items for advanced winter recreation such as ice climbing tools and backcountry skis.

Funding we receive will be used to purchase items in the order of those three priorities. We would like at minimum to outfit a full trip per weekend (8 participants) for basic winter overnight travel. At an intermediate level of funding we would outfit another full trip per weekend (8 participants) for basic winter overnight travel. At a full level of funding we would outfit two trips per weekend (4 participants each) for ice climbing and backcountry skiing.

We emphasize that most of this equipment has a twenty-year lifespan even with constant use: it will form the core of Yale outing clubs' winter equipment for many years. The funding requested is the initial seed for this initiative—not an annual operating cost.

The rental fee list (*Section X, Appendix A: Gear Rental Prices*) contains the approximate price of new gear under the "Deposit" column. When items are purchased in bulk under preferred arrangements with gear dealers and manufacturers, lower prices can be found. Exact prices depend on market conditions and seasonal sales.

We conservatively estimate the cost of gear per person to be the following:

- Basic winter overnight travel: $850/person
  (boots, pack, bag, tent, shovel, poles, axe, crampons/snowshoes)
- Additional cost for ice climbing: $400/person
  (technical axe, plastic boots, technical crampons)
- Additional cost for backcountry skiing: $750/person
  (skis, boots, bindings, avalanche safety gear)

At these estimated prices, the three levels of funding outlined above would amount to:

- **Minimum funding: $6,800**
- **Intermediate funding: $13,600**
- **Full funding: $18,200**

The receipt of these funds, to be deposited by Yale Outdoors or Yale Mountaineering Club, would make Yale's first—and subsequent—annual Winter Schools possible.

X. Appendices

Appendix A: Yale Winter School Gear Rental Prices

Item	Deposit	Daily Rental
Car-camping 2-4 person tent	$200	$3
Car-camping 6 person tent	$200	$10
Backpacking 3-season tent	$250	$5
Backpacking 4-season tent	$450	$7
3-season sleeping bag (15 - 30º) (inc. stuff sack)	$250	$4
Winter sleeping bag (-15 - 0º) (inc. stuff sack)	$400	$5
Foam pad	$25	$1
Stove (inc. fuel)	$75	$3
Bear canister	$75	$2
Water jug	$10	$1
Flashlight	$10	$1
Cooking pot	$30	$1
Wool blanket	$30	$1
Snow saw	$30	$1
Gas lantern (inc. fuel)	$50	$3
Climbing shoes	$150	$3
Climbing helmet	$75	$1
Climbing harness	$50	$2
Ice climbing (technical) ice axe (each)	$250	$7
Ice climbing (technical) crampons	$200	$5
Daypack	$100	$2
Internal frame pack	$300	$5
Plastic boots	$350	$6
General use crampons	$125	$3
Step-in crampons	$150	$5
Crampon bag	$25	$1
Alpine ice axe	$100	$2
Snowshoes	$175	$5
Snow shovel	$50	$1
Snow fluke	$30	$1
Hiking poles	$25	$1
Touring skis	$200	$4
Touring ski boots	$75	$2
BC skis	$250	$5
BC ski boots	$150	$3
3-pin skis (inc. 3-pin boots & hiking poles)	$40	$2
Ski poles (for 2)	$50	$2
Ski skins	$120	$2

Appendix B: Leader Resumes

Prospective leaders are encouraged to renew or obtain Wilderness First Aid (WFA) certification before February 2009. Current certification (or the equivalent training or background) is required of all primary trip leaders. Below is a brief summary of leader ratings:

Ratings by Location:
* A: one hour from intensive care (ski tracks, short hikes from the road, etc)
* B: anything below treeline
* C: above treeline

Ratings by Activity:
* I: Ice Climbing
* S: Ski Mountaineering

**Activity ratings are subordinate to location ratings: e.g. a {B,S} leader can only lead ski mountaineering trips below treeline. Co-ratings are given to those who show promise in an area but have not demonstrated the specific experience/leadership/group management necessary for a full rating. This allows them to gain experience as the leader of a trip in this area under the supervision/backup of a more experienced leader. Full C ratings have typically been denied to people who have not acted as the primary leader on at least one winter school trip in above treeline conditions (e.g. co-leader who runs the show).

For example, {A, CoB, CoI} can act as primary leader on A-level trips, can co-lead B-level trips with a full B leader, and can co-lead ice climbing trips as long as they qualify as B level or below.

**WFA or higher is required for all B and C leaders.

Please fill in the details below and submit your resumé to us.

Name:
Email: (You will be sent a confirmation email to this address.)
Phone:
Yale Affiliation: (e.g. Undergrad, grad student, staff, alum, etc)
Previous Leader Rating (if applicable):
Desired Leader Rating:
Formal Training:

Please give details of any medical training and qualifications, with dates, along with any relevant winter training and qualifications. Enter 'none' if required.

Winter Experience:

Please give details of previous winter trip experience. Include approx dates and locations, no. of participants, trail conditions, type of trip (x-country ski, hike, above treeline, snow-shoe, etc):

Trip Leading Details:

Please give details of whether you participated, led or co-led the above trips:

Notes/Comments:

Appendix C: Participant Waiver Form

Personal Information:

Full Name: _____ Date of Birth: _____

Home Address:

_____

Local Phone Number:

_____

Height: _____ Weight: _____ Sex:____

Emergency Contact #1:

Name, relationship to you: _____

Phone: Day: _____ Evening: _____

Emergency Contact #2:

Name, relationship to you: _____

Phone: Day: _____ Evening: _____

Health Care Information:

Health Care Provider: _____ Number(s): _____

Name of physician/primary care provider _____ Phone _____

Name of dentist_____ Phone _____

I understand that I am participating in this event at my own risk. I acknowledge that Yale University and Yale Outdoors are not responsible for any injury, damage, or loss suffered by me in connection with my participation in this activity. I understand that participating in many outdoor activities is less safe than staying home; often, the entire point of a trip is to do something that contains inherent risk. I hereby release and hold harmless, Yale University and Yale Outdoors and their officers, directors, employees, and agents from liability for such injury, damage, or loss, including without limitation liability for medical treatment. I certify that I have adequate health insurance, and that I am physically able to participate in this activity. In the event that I should require emergency care, and none of the above contacts may be reached, I give permission for such care to be given.

_____ _____

Signature of Participant Date

I further agree to reimburse Yale Outdoors, its leaders, or any other member of the club for any damage that I may cause, intentional or unintentional, to equipment or personal property while participating in this event. If I am borrowing gear from Yale Outdoors or it s leaders, I promise to return it or replace it with the same item of equal or greater value within a week following the end of the trip.

Appendix D: Health History Form

The participant of the trip must fill in the following information. This information will be kept confidential and used only in the event of an emergency. Please notify a Yale Outdoors leader of any changes to this form that may occur.

ALLERGIES: List all known (medication, food, other), and describe reaction and management
Medication allergies (list)

_____

_____

MEDICATIONS BEING TAKEN - include ALL medication (including over-the-counter or nonprescription drugs) taken routinely

_____

_____

RESTRICTIONS

Dietary - please describe any dietary restrictions: _____

_____

Explain any restrictions to activity (e.g. any limitations, what adaptations are necessary):

_____

Anything else, including recent injuries, chronic health problems, past surgeries or conditions of which we should know:

_____

_____

_____

_____

I certify that all the above information is true to the best of my knowledge.

_____ _____

Appendix E: Yale Mountaineering Club Gear Inventory

Last Update:		**12/18/08**			
Item	**#**	**Brand**	**Specs**	**Price**	**Date Acquired**
80' (Static?) Rope	1		White with red and black strand		
Single Length Sling	1	Trango	Blue		
Single Length Sling	1	Ragged Mountain	Blue tubular webbing		
Single Length Sling	1	Trango	Orange		
Single Length Sling	1	Black Diamond	Red		
Whistle	1				
Quad Length Sling	1	Wild Country	Yellow		
Locking Caribiner	2	Petzl	Spinball; Red electrical tape		
Wire-gate Caribiner	2	Camp	Silver		
Bent-gate	2	Trango	Purple gate; "Bolt End"		
Oval Caribiner	1	Black Diamond	Red Electrical Tape		

Cams	5	Trango	MaxCam: .5, 1 (2x), 2, 3		
Gear Shoulder Sling	1	Metolius	4 Loops		
Harness	1		Black; Fixed Leg; Orange/Red and Green Design		
Harness	1		Black; Fixed Leg; Red and Tan design		
Chalk	1	Metolius	Super Chalk - Fine Grind		
Shoes	1	Five.Ten	Size 44.5 (US 11); Blue		
Shoes	1	Evolv	Size 39 (US 6.5); Black		
Shoes	1	Mad Rock	Size 39.5 (US 7); White		
Shoes	1	Bufo	Size 45; Royal Blue; Sole Peeling Off (Right Foot)		
Shoes	1	Bufo	Size 42; Red		
Shoes	1	Bufo	Size 43; Red		
Shoes	1	Bufo	Size 46; Red; Sole Peeling off (Both)		
Shoes	1	Five.Ten	Size 41.5 (US 8.5); Purple		
Shoes	0.5	Bufo	Size 41; Red; Missing Left Shoe		
Shoes	1	Bufo	Size 39; Black; "Shark"		
Harness	8	Trango	Cosmic	$44.95	11/24/08
Belay Device	8	Mammut	Fuse; ATC; tube style	$15.95	11/24/08
Locking Caribiner	20	Mammut	Element HMS; Screwlock	$10.95	11/24/08
Helmet	8	Mammut	Skywalker	$59.95	11/24/08
Dynamic Rope	3	Mammut	Matterhorn; 10.2mm; Superdry; 60m	$185.00	11/24/08
Static Rope	1	Mammut	10.5mm Performance Statik; 100m	$219.00	11/24/08
Double Length Sling	4	Mammut	8mm Contact Sling; Blue	$11.95	11/24/08
Cordelette	1		7mm Cordelette; 20 feet	$8.25	11/24/08

Appendix F: Yale Outdoors Gear Inventory

Last update:	**12/15/08**					
Type	**Item**	**#**	**Brand**	**Specs**	**Price**	**Date bought**
Backpacking/ snow equipmt						
	Backpack parts			2 extra internal frame stays		
	Backpacks	5	2 internal, 3 external	Campmor Camp Trails Triad 70 (internal, 4720 cu in, 3lb 5oz), Mountainsmith Cross Country (internal, 4600 cu in, 5lb), Kelty Ridgeway (external, 3950 cu in, 4lb 9oz), Jansport ancient external (estimate: 3500 cu in, for short torso), Campmor Camp Trails McKinley (external, 3500 cu in, 5lb 2oz)		

	Compass	1				
	Crampons	6 (pairs)	Covell Ice Walker	4-points; neoprene straps		
	Flashlight	1				
	Ice axes	6	Black Diamond Raven	1 60cm, 4 65cm, 1 80cm; general mountaineering; 485g (17oz)	$49/ea	4/8/08
	Nordic ski boots	1 pair	Rossignol	US mens 12, NNNII binding		
	Pads	9	Texsport pack lite mattress	closed cell, 3/8" thick (they're thin); 20"X72"; very lightweight		
	Pads	1	Insul Mat	Full-length/thick inflatable mattress; missing a bag		
	4 person 3-season tent	1		REI Taj III		
[lost]	Sleeping bag	1	Coleman Exponent	synthetic (Dupont Quallofil with Allerban); down to 0F; size: 33"X85"; pack weight: 5lb 4oz		
	Sleeping bag liner	1	Salt mummy liner	adds 5 degrees F, nylon, 5oz		
	Snowshoes	5 pairs	3 Redfeather Hike, 1 Atlas X7 Series, 1 unknown	Redfeather: (Model 30 (?), user weight up to 220lbs, 3.7lbs); Atlas: (30in?, for mostly packed/broken trails); unknown: (25 in (up to 175lbs??), duct-taped rigging on one)		
	Tarp	1		with grommets -- for ground or roof?		
	Tent parts			extra poles (from what tent?)		
	Tent repair kit	1	Coghlan's	canvas cement, needle, material, screen		
	Tent stakes	18	Campmor	heavy-duty metal; 3-4oz/stake?; stored in sleeping bag sack		
	Trekking poles	1 pair	REI Summit Trekking 7075-T6	3-section collapsible pole; twist-close joints		
	Bowls	70		Styrofoam		
Kitchen equipt	Bowls	150		paper		
	Camp ware			7 plastic plates, 5 plastic camp cups, 3 plastic tumbler cups, 3 shallow metal bowls, 3 metal pie tins, 1 deep metal bowl, measuring cup (1.5c)		
	Cookware			GSI Halulite Double Boiler (1L and 0.5L nesting pots; hard anodized alloy; clear Lexan lid; mesh stuff sack; 4.875" X 5.25" travel dimensions; 11.8oz); MSR BlackLite Classic Non-Stick Aluminum Cookset (2L and 1L pots, fitted lid, packtowl, panhandler, stuff sack; 18oz; use plastic utensils); topless aluminum 48oz (?) with broken handle,		Feb-08
	Egg crate	1		plastic; holds dozen		
	Forks	500		plastic		
	Fuel bottle	2	Nalgene	Plastic 32 oz		
	Fuel bottles	2	MSR	metal; 22oz, 33oz		
	Iodine			enough for 1L water		
	Kitchen utensils			peeler/corkscrew/bottle opener/can opener, 2 flipper, random shit, 2 bottle/can openers, 2 graters, 3 peelers, pizza slicer, measuring spoons, stirring spoon		
	Knives	40		plastic		

	Packable plastic spice containers	2				
	Plates	50		paper		
	Pot holder	2				
	Pot-grabber	1				
	Shish ka bab skewers	50		bag		
	Soap	1	Dr. Bronner's Peppermint Soap	organic, 4oz		
	Spoons	40		plastic		
	Stove	1	Optimus Stove in a Box	?		
	Stove	1	MSR WhisperLite			
	Stove part		WhisperLite fuel connection	duct-taped		
	Toothpicks	1		small box		
	Water bladders	3	Stearns	1 gal?		
	Water bladders	2	Ortlieb	5 L (?)		
	Water filter	1	Katadyn pump			
	Water filter		Sweet Water pump			
First Aid						
	Bandaids					
	Candles	8		2in		
	Citronella candle	1	Coghlan's	in can; burns 16-18hrs; 3.5oz		
	Face mask	1				
	Hand sanitizer	1		2oz		
	Hydrogen peroxide	1		16oz		
	Imodium			anti-diarrheal (6 caps)		
	Insect repellent	2		2.5oz Jungle Juice, 6oz OFF,		
	Med kit	2	NA	in sleeping bag sack: 15 4"X4" sterile pads, moleskin packet, 3 gauze roll, 2 ace bandages, 2 pairs latex gloves, bacitracin, hydrocortisone, sports tape, vaseline, 12 diphenhydramine HCL, 19 Tums, 21 anti-diarrheal, 37 200mg Ibuprofen, 63 500mg Acetamino		
	Med kit bags	3				
	Nitrile gloves (no latex)	30?		box		
	Space blanket	2		unpackaged		
	Sports tape	1		roll		
	Sterile pads					
Miscellaneous						
	Extra sacks	4		mesh pillow-size, mesh purifier size, nylon water bottle holder,		

				med-size stuff sack,		
	Frisbee	1				
	Garbage bags	50?		black plastic and clear plastic; 30gal?		
	Lighter	1	Bic			
	Matches	1		waterproof matches (box)		
	Nails			box		
	Plastic bottle	3		8oz		
	Straps/buckles/etc			3 nylon 1"X3'; 10ft wire twine; lengths of 3mm nylon; 2 bungee cords; wide plastic waist strap buckle; 5 bent lightweight metal tent stakes; assorted other		
	Propane Fuel (8 oz)	1 and a bit				
	stove top	1		MSR		

END

Winter School Budget Sheet

The following budget sheet was submitted for YCC, UOFC, Dean's and President's funding:

BUDGET SHEET
Yale Mountaineering Club (YMC) Winter School (Event dates: February 2-March 1)
Refer questions to Spencer Gray, President, YMC (spencer.gray@yale.edu)
Items will be purchased according to the three prioritized pools below, up to a maximum level of $27,541.

Equipment	Price/item	Number	Price/set
IMMEDIATE PRIORITIES			
Winter hiking boots	$69.00	30	$2,070.00
Mountaineering crampons	$65.00	20	$1,300.00
Mountaineering axes	$45.00	14	$630.00
Snowshoes	$110.00	15	$1,650.00
Poles	$64.00	20	$1,280.00
Crampon bags	$15.00	20	$300.00
Sanitary defecation bags	$3.00	100	$300.00
IMMEDIATE TOTAL			**$7,530.00**
SECONDARY PRIORITIES			
Four-season tents	$350.00	4	$1,400.00
Winter sleeping bags	$120.00	20	$2,400.00
Snow shovels	$25.00	10	$250.00
Alpine touring boots	$170.00	30	$5,100.00
Alpine touring bindings	$260.00	10	$2,600.00
Ski climbing skins	$55.00	10	$550.00
Avalanche beacons	$240.00	6	$1,440.00
Avalanche probes	$40.00	10	$400.00
Snow pickets	$20.00	2	$40.00
Snow flukes	$35.00	2	$70.00
Headlamps	$20.00	10	$200.00
Cooking pot sets	$40.00	4	$160.00
Snow saws	$37.00	3	$111.00
Camping lanterns	$25.00	3	$75.00
SECONDARY TOTAL			**$14,796.00**
TERTIARY PRIORITIES			
Alpine touring skis	$200.00	10	$2,000.00
Car ski rack	$75.00	1	$75.00
Technical crampons	$115.00	8	$920.00
Technical axes	$120.00	16	$1,920.00
Pads	$15.00	20	$300.00
TERTIARY TOTAL			**$5,215.00**
TOTAL FOR THREE PRIORITIES			**$27,541.00**

Winter School Trip Protocol

Winter School trip leaders are given the following protocol for planning trips.

Yale Winter School Trip Protocol 2009
If you are going to lead a trip during Winter School, plan on the following:

- By **Monday**: decide and commit to a specific trip; discuss it with other club leaders at WS pre-lecture meeting or YO meeting (both at 6:30pm).
- By **Tuesday**: post the trip online: yalemountaineering.org/trips.aspx; include info about when (during office hours) you will rent gear together [Username: "YMC" Password: "weclimbon"].
- **Wednesday**: sign-up begins
- **Thursday**: send an e-mail to participants w/ further information about the trip and info you need from them (see the *pre-trip example e-mail*); don't assume everyone who signs up should be going—communicate with individuals if you are unsure of their fitness or preparedness. Coordinate what time to meet for rental.
- **Thursday** night:
    - At least one leader must rent gear with the group, including group gear (tents, med kits, etc). Look at the *required gear list* for group gear requirements.
    - Leaders pay no rental fees.
    - Participants leave a security deposit check (checks highly preferred; alternative: credit card information) for: trip fee ($5), rental, and (if applicable) membership fee; they can also pay trip fees and/or membership fees immediately.
    - While your group rents gear, first-time participants must fill out a *medical form and waiver*: leave these with the gear room staff.
    - If you want, you can also collected estimated gas money at this time.
- By **Friday** night: send *relevant info* to that weekend's Trip WIMP.
- **After trip**: contact Trip WIMP immediately; fill out *Trip Report*.

All of the relevant forms (*Required gear lists, Pre-trip example e-mail, Medical form/Waiver, Trip WIMP protocol, Trip Report form, and this Protocol*) are here:
yalemountaineering.org/docs

Example E-mail

The following is the example e-mail distributed to Winter School leaders to make sure they lead well-planned, safe trips:

```
Dear Mt. Monroe Trip Participants

Please READ the following advice on your trip. ALL of you should read
the following in its entirety.

The following is instructions and advice on your Winter School trip.
Please read it IN ITS ENTIRETY.  Please complete the section at the bottom
and return the information to me and Mike Kokko ASAP, along with any
questions.
_____________

LEADERS:

Dave Wentzlaff (555.555.5555) & Mike Kokko (777.777.7777)
_____________

THE ROUTE:

We'll hike Mt. Monroe from Marshfield Station at the base of the Cog
Railway in Bretton Woods, NH.  From the station, we'll take the
Ammonoosuc Ravine Trail up past the AMC Lakes of the Clouds Hut and on
to the summit of Mt. Monroe.  This hike will be 7.2 miles round-trip
and will involve about 3000' of elevation gain.  FULL ABOVE-TREELINE
GEAR INCLUDING BODY COVER, CRAMPONS, AND
AN ICE AXE IS REQUIRED.

_____________

CONTINGENCY PLANS:

As always, a winter ascent in the White Mountains is a gamble. Trips
frequently get to treeline and have to turn around due to high winds.
Make sure that you are comfortable using an Ice-axe and crampons.
Also, make sure that you have tested out the gear well in advance of
the actual trip. A proper fit on crampons & snowshoes is absolutely
vital for your safety and the safety of others. If in doubt, consult
your trip leader well in advance of the trip, or as a last resort, at
the trail-head BEFORE starting the hike.

 _____________

EDUCATIONAL OBJECTIVES:

This trip will offer an opportunity for participants to test their
winter hiking, navigation, crampon/snowshoe, and above-treeline skills.

_____________

TENTATIVE SCHEDULE:
```

Saturday, 8:15am: Meet at the Cog Railway base station (It is most efficient to come up I-93 and then head toward Crawford Notch, look for Cog Railway signs)
Saturday, 8:30am: Start up th Ammonoosuc Ravine Trail
Saturday, 4:30pm: Return to cars via Ammonoosuc Ravine Trail

GEAR:

By now, you should have a pretty good feel for what gear is expected of you on a trip like this, but here's a checklist for your convenience. Not all of this gear is explicitly required, but check with me if you're afraid you might be lacking in a particular area.

Rental:

* Boot/crampon system that you have used previously with success. CRAMPONS REQUIRED.
* Snowshoes
* Backpack (should be big enough to carry all your things. Try not to stuff everything into a smaller bag!)
* Sleeping Pad

Clothing:

* Legs: non-cotton long underwear (wicking), fleece pants/shell (warm, wind/water-resistant top layer)
* Body: non-cotton undershirt (wicking), fleece/wool warming layer (warming), water/wind-resistant shell (water/windproofing)
* Gloves: non-cotton glove liners (wicking), warm gloves or mittens (warming, two pair recommended), wind/water-resistant overmitts (water/windproofing)
* Face/Head: warm hat, face mask or balaclava, ski goggles

FULL BODY COVER IS REQUIRED - NO EXCEPTIONS!

When it's all on, is there any exposed skin? If there is, you need more clothes or a better balaclava/face mask.

* Feet: non-cotton liner socks (wicking), warm wool socks (warming), warm boots (waterproofing), crampons that fit your boots (Make sure they fit before you leave Boston!), gaiters (duct tape can be a great substitute)

Other personal gear:

* At least 2-3 quarts of water, preferably in wide-mouth bottles
* Ice axe and/or hiking poles ICE AXE REQUIRED.
* headlamp (Required!)
* compass (Required!)
* whistle (Required!)
* trail food
* space blanket (a good idea)
* your leaders will provide you with a copy of the map
* Bring your cell phone or two-way radio if you have one.

Your leaders will also carry (and may ask you to assist in carrying):

* sleeping bag (at least one -15 and one 0-degree bag per team)
* Pads (preferably one for every two participants)
* stove and fuel (at least one per team)
* emergency shelter (tent)

_____

WEATHER:

The ground forecast for Bretton Woods, NH is cold with highs in the low 20's (F) and light winds. Conditions on the mountain will be significantly colder, especially above treeline. Remember that the weather can change quickly and being prepared is key.

_____

EXPENSES:

Winter School Trip fee is $5 per day, to cover White Mountain Guide Permits and safety gear. Please pay this at office hours before the trip, or afterwards if you are renting gear. Plan to pay about $20 to your driver to help cover gas and maintenance costs. Bring some extra cash for breakfast, snacks, and other incidentals.

_____

PERSONAL PRE-TRIP PREPARATION:

Looking for even more information about the trip and the skills involved? Here's what you can do:

Study the map:
- TopoZone:
http://www.topozone.com/map.asp?lat=44.26688&lon=-71.32647&size=l&u=4&datum=nad83&layer=DRG25
- AMC Guide on Map 1 (Presidentials)
- Read about the area in the AMC White Mountains Guide:
http://www.amazon.com/exec/obidos/tg/detail/-/1929173229/

Read about ice axe and crampon usage in "Freedom of the Hills":
http://www.amazon.com/exec/obidos/tg/detail/-/0898864275/

Ask your trip leaders ANY QUESTIONS you might have.

_____

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU:

Please return the following information to me and Mike Kokko by Noon on Friday.

Name:
Cell Phone#:
Home Phone#:
Home/Local contact Name (ie. Roommate):
Home/Local contact Phone#:
Home/Local contact Relation:
Emergency contact Name (ie. Parents):
Emergency contact Phone#:
Emergency contact Relation:

Any Allergies (food, drug, insect, etc.):
Pertinent medical history:
Current medications & medical conditions:
Dietary restrictions:

Medical training:
Personal objectives for this trip (optional):

Rider info (passengers only)
Your driver:

Car info (drivers only)
Make:
Model:
Year:
Color:
Description (ie. 4-door Sedan):
Distinguishing Feature (ie. Stickers):
License Plate State:
License Plate #:
Passengers:
_____

Thanks for reading this through. Please Get me the info above ASAP!
See everyone Saturday!

- Mike Kokko (777.777.7777) & Dave Wentzlaff (555.555.5555)

WIMP Procedures

Winter School follows the safety procedures below to ensure trip itineraries are being shared and that someone will initiate search and rescue if need be.

WIMP Procedures

Yale Winter School 2009

WIMP is an acronym for "Worry If Missing Person." Each weekend of Winter School, someone will be designated as the WIMP. This person will be in charge of making sure that all trips return safely, and to alert emergency services if a trip does not report back. The procedures for both trip leaders and the WIMP are outlined below. **All Trips Must Follow WIMP Procedures.**

The WIMP for the weekend of Feb X-Y is Z.

Instructions for Trip Leaders

- Before noon on Friday, email the WIMP with the following information:
  - Name and contact info for both leaders and all students on the trip.
  - Description (make, model, color) and plate #'s for each vehicle.
  - Intended route, alternate (i.e. bailout) route, trailhead/parking lot.
  - Worry Time. This should be **3 hours** after you plan to be back at the cars. Plan conservatively, especially for beginner trips.
- If plans change before you start hiking, email or call the WIMP about the changes.
- Explain the WIMP procedure to your students, and have them remind you to call the WIMP after the trip.
- When you return safely to the cars, call the WIMP **IMMEDIATELY!**
  - Don't wait until after you get dinner or arrive at Camelot.
  - Cell phone service in the mountains is spotty at best, so you may need to drive a few miles before you pick up a signal.
  - Batteries do not work well when cold. Keep your phone warm or have a car charger as backup.
  - If the WIMP does not pick up, then leave a message. It's not a bad idea to try again a little bit later even if you leave a message.

If there is an accident, let the WIMP know after contacting emergency services.

Instructions for the WIMP

Distribute your contact information to the leaders by Thursday.

Collect trip information. Harass delinquent leaders at your discretion.

Make a list of all the trips out and their Worry Times, preferably in chronological order. Keep this list handy for the weekend.

Check off trips as they report back.

If a trip does not report back before its Worry Time.

Try calling the leaders.

Wait 30 minutes, then call the leaders again, then call the students. Repeat every 30 minutes. Also try calling someone at each of the cabins, if possible, to see if the trip has returned to there.

If no contact is made by 2 hours after the Worry Time (5 hours after expected return time), then call the appropriate emergency number.

For trips in NH, contact the NH State Police at 800-525-5555 or 911.

For trips in VT, contact the VT State Police by calling the nearest state police station (List of numbers at http://www.dps.state.vt.us/vtsp/contactus.html) or 911.

For trips in ME, contact the ME State Police by calling the nearest state police station (List of numbers at http://www.maine.gov/dps/msp/) or 911.

For trips in MA, contact the MA State Police by calling 911.

Trip gear requirements

Winter School trip leaders and participants are requested to follow the gear requirements below.

Yale Winter School Trip Gear Requirements

Types of trips:

By Location: **A**: One hour from intensive care (short hikes from the road, etc)
B: Anything below treeline
C: Above treeline
By Activity: **I**: Ice climbing
S: Ski mountaineering
O: Overnight

These are conservative gear requirements. Follow them as closely as possible.

Individual Gear (All Participants)

LEADERS SHOULD ENSURE ALL PARTICIPANTS HAVE

- Whistle
- Compass
- Map (photocopy provided by leader is sufficient)
- Headlamp or flashlight

Group Gear

Trip leaders must ensure that collectively their group carries the following gear according to trip type.

A Trip

- First-aid kit
- Extra clothing
- Extra Food
- Duct Tape
- Parachute Cord or Webbing
- Foampad (optional)

B Trip

➢ Everything for an A Trip plus:

- 2 winter sleeping bags
- 1 foam pad for every 2 people
- Winter rated stove w/ pot, lid, fuel (min 22oz, 33oz recommended), water-proof matches and/or lighter
- Additional fire starter (magnesium chips or candle)
- Shelter/Tent: 2 bivy bags or tarp

C Trip

➢ Everything for a B Trip plus...

- Shelter/Tent: First-lite or Trango (required!)
- Shovel (required)
- Wands (optional)

S Trip

➢ Everything for a B or C Trip plus...

- Shovel

Overnight Trip

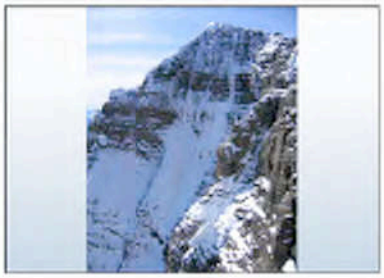
➢ Everything for a C Trip plus...

- Shovel
- Adequate shelter for everyone

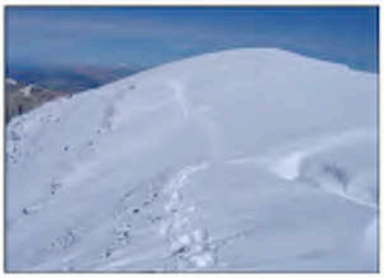
Winter School lecture example

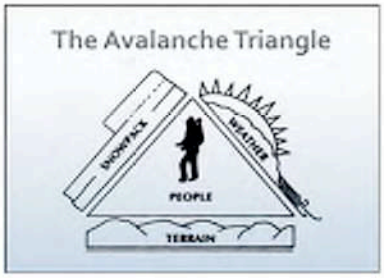
The following screenshots are an example of one lecture given during Winter School. It is on avalanche safety.

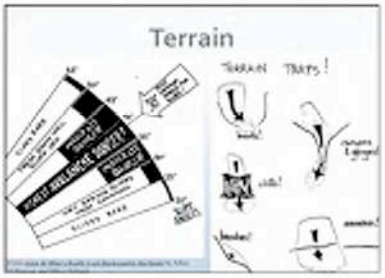




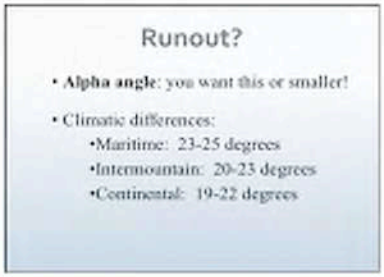


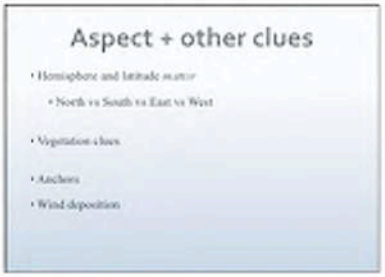



The Avalanche Triangle
SNOWPACK
WEATHER
PEOPLE
TERRAIN


Terrain
TERRAIN TRAPS!

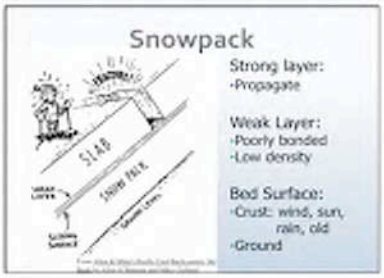

What is the slope connected to?
Crown


Runout?
• Alpha angle: you want this or smaller!
• Climatic differences:
•Maritime: 23-25 degrees
•Intermountain: 20-23 degrees
•Continental: 19-22 degrees


Aspect + other clues
• Hemisphere and latitude matter
• North vs South vs East vs West
• Vegetation clues
• Anchors
• Wind deposition

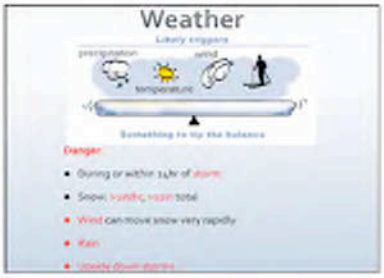





Snowpack
Strong layer:
·Propagate
Weak Layer:
·Poorly bonded
·Low density
Bed Surface:
·Crust: wind, sun, rain, old
·Ground
SLAB
SNOW PACK


Weak Layers
•Lots to say about different weak layers
•Important factor within snowpack:
temperature gradient
•Becomes a vapor gradient
•Critical: 1 deg. C / 10 cm
•But much less important than loading
•Example: Rockies snowpack Christmas 2008




Weather
Likely triggers
precipitation
wind
temperature
Something to tip the balance
Danger
During or within 24hr of storm
Snow: >30cm, >50cm total
Wind can move snow very rapidly
Rain


CANADA


Human Factor
Primary Factor in Both of Fatal Accidents*
Group dynamics
Objective evaluation
Decision making

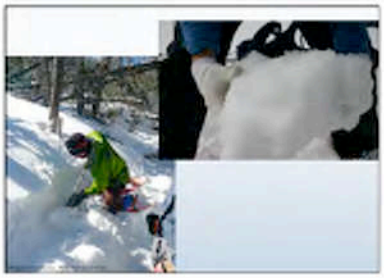

Avalanche Report
Low
Moderate
Considerable
High
Extreme
Natural
Human
Avalanche Advisory for Tuckerman and Huntington Ravines


Safe Travel Techniques
Look up!
Route picking (look at the map before)
Carry Rescue Tools
When In Questionable Areas
One at a time
Never cross above partner
Escape routes (islands of safety)
No straps
Minimal exposure time
Cross high
Belay rope
Climb naked

Overall Assesment

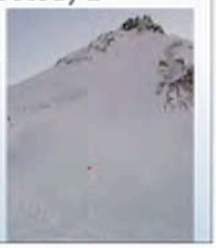
- Avy report
- Knowledge of area
- On The Fly:
  - Recent avies?
  - Observations
  - **Whoomph**
- Snow Pits



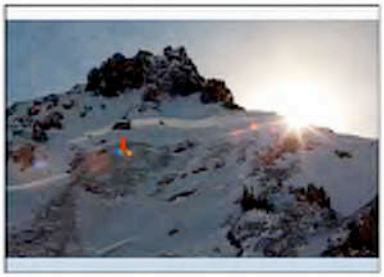


Case study 1

- January 19, 2009 southern Montana







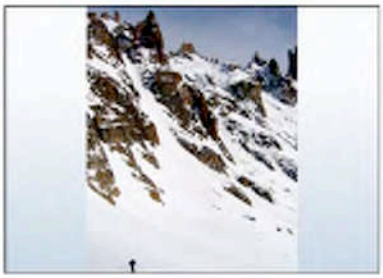
The Accident Report

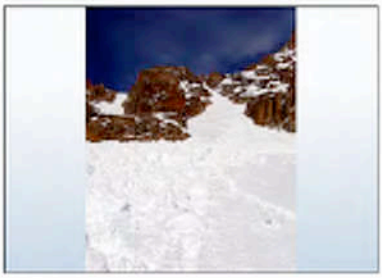
- On Saturday a rider was killed in a large avalanche on Crown Butte next to Daisy Pass. His snowmobile was stuck high on a northeast facing slope near 10,000 ft at the end of the day. As he worked to free his sled, it began to tumble downhill. It rolled 3/4 times before striking a rock, and the slope fractured 300 feet wide running 1000 ft vertical. Slope angles in the starting zone were 37-40 degrees and the crown had a maximum height of 10-15 ft. The victim's four partners immediately conducted a very thorough beacon search but could not detect a signal. A search continued the following day, and he was located with an avalanche dog. He was found under 3 feet of snow with his beacon accidentally turned off.

Case study 2

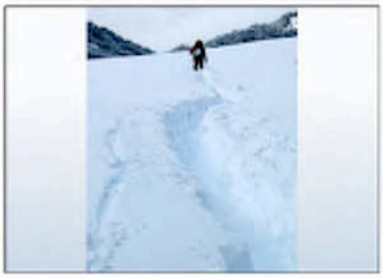
- Facts:
  - Maritime climate mid-winter
  - First day: no new snow in a week, consolidated snowpack
  - Last day: 3 feet new snow
  - Knowledge of snowpack?
- Question: what to do on the last day?







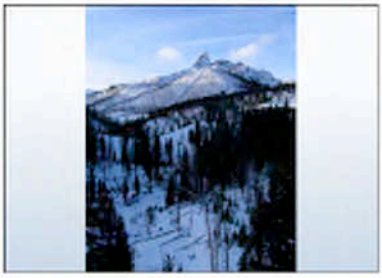


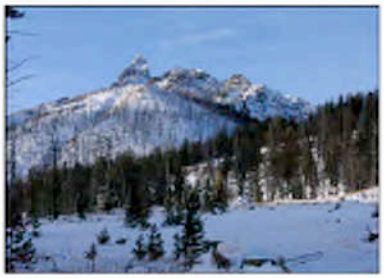





Case study 3
Facts:
Question: What route should we pick?

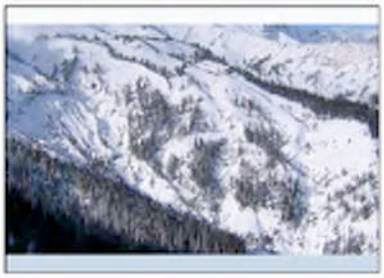


















Send in a report!

"Thought I'd share what we observed on an overnight ski trip the last 2 days up Pilot Ck off the Beartooth Highway.

Yesterday: "Those awful winds loading slopes like crazy and breaking dead tree limbs and trees, cracks spreading from our ski tracks over 10 or 15 degree treadlines. Stayed off anything 30 degrees or more. Yesterday afternoon, failed to launch a 30 degree slope w/ a heavy rope attached at ~6pm/8. Had not yet released this morning, but other similar slopes at just about treeline w/ bigger connected hist.

Friday: At ~12pm triggered a wall on a 35 degree slope at ~3300 feet, NE exposure on the far SE spur of Pilot Peak (immediately above Pilot Ck). Took a lot of stomping, ~50ft wide crown was 2-3' high, heavily wind-loaded slab, broke on thick layer of heavily faceted snow. Twitter safe and sound, good holes left up.

Thanks for all your great work with advisories this season. We're lucky to have this service."

—[redacted]

Some videos

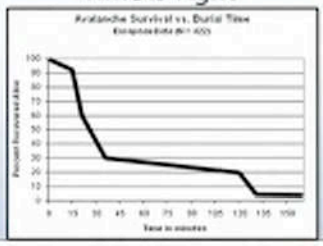
- Helmet cam with AvaLung in Alaska: http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6CzeWRvZqKU
- 5th skier at Talkeetna, 3000' ride, broken scapula: http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cDkpoBRKck
- Switzerland slide: http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6qVwIuvdFWs&feature=related

Surviving an avalanche

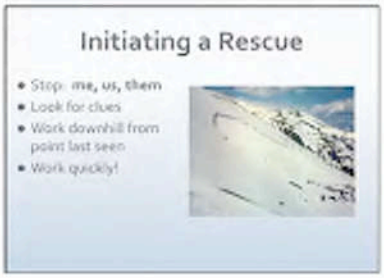


- Yell
- Try to ski out (~45 degrees)
- Drop ski equipment
- Swim
- Grab a tree
- Create airspace
- Thrust a hand upward
- Conserve O2 (relax!)
- Wear a beacon!
- ~15 seconds; 4 minutes consciousness

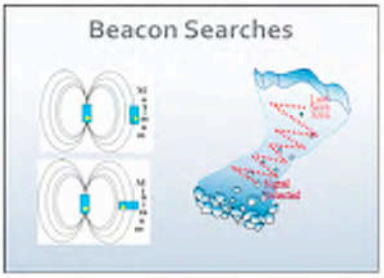
Time is Tight



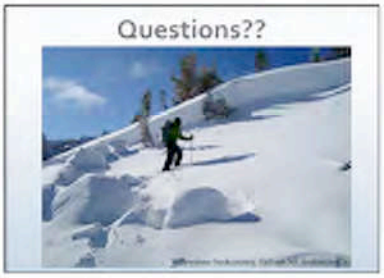

Rescue Tools
Beacons
Probes
Shovels


Initiating a Rescue
Stop: me, us, them
Look for clues
Work downhill from point last seen
Work quickly!




Beacon Searches


Resources


Questions??

Future Plans

Yale Outdoors plans to expand its activities to focus on the following objectives.

- **Regular events**: YO will focus on holding a few recurring events each year. Winter School is a good start. An Earth Week collaboration with YSEC is a possibility already explored in 2009. A third event early in the fall semester (a kind of 'Fall Circus') would anchor the calendar.

- **Faculty/staff support**: YO is recruiting a member or members of the Yale faculty or staff to serve as advisers to the group as it moves forward with its expanded activities.

- **Alumni network**: YO's institutional memory and fundraising possibilities would be helped by an associated alumni group. This group could serve as a kind of board of overseers or advisory council, depending on the oversight needs of YO (which will mostly depend on how much money it is administering). The LGBT Co-op and YSEC both have something of this sort.

- **Endowment**: This is the long-term financial goal of YO. It will depend on two things: alumni fund-raising and the willingness of Yale to administer the fund. Examples of what could be done with an endowment: purchasing gear; holding annual essay prizes; funding student expeditions; subsidizing gas money or climbing gym membership; paying speaker fees.

- **FOOT**: YO will continue to develop its relationship with FOOT. FOOT at present is the most organized and well-recognized outdoor group on campus. Hundreds of students spend their first days as Yalies in the woods; their first entry into Yale is at a trailhead. It is generally a very positive experience, and is very similar to the kind of experience that YO wants to make available. FOOT is a big and autonomous group, but it still might serve as a welcome mat to outdoor recreation at Yale.

  More specifically, YO would like a FOOT Core Head to serve as a liaison to YO. FOOT and YO might jointly facilitate WFA courses. And most importantly, FOOT and YO could share gear. If YO develops good gear room procedures, holding members accountable for the gear they rent, and maintaining gear throughout the year, it might be possible to share FOOT gear, give FOOT the rental fees collected on it, and help FOOT move gear as needed for May Training and August trips.

- **Website**: YO will adopt the structure of YMC's website, which has a code that can be easily altered in future semesters by a webmaster minimally competent in html.

- **Panlists**: YO will consider creating separate panlists for different outdoor activities. One large general YO panlist could remain for regular announcements, but then members could sign up for separate panlists with only news about, for example, canoeing events. This might require switching from the Pantheon to the Mailman panlists so that members could sign up themselves.

IV. Desired from the Yale Administration

Over the next two years Yale Outdoors will focus on the following short- and long-term requests of the Yale administration (in relative order of priority):

1. A central office on campus to store gear, hold meetings, and coordinate trips and events. Possibilities include in the new residential colleges, in an adjacent building, in Payne Whitney, or in the basement of Bingham Hall. The location should be accessible to all members of the Yale community. It should have wireless and be large enough to accommodate a table or two and gear racks lining the walls.

   We have over $20,000 in gear that needs a proper home. We have the rental and maintenance procedures for taking care of it. We just need a stable, accessible space for it.

2. Solicitation of alumni donations to expand outdoor activity at Yale. Once we have a list of alumni, especially of YMC, from the Association of Yale Alumni, we need to receive permission from the Office of Development to solicit donations. This includes submission of a form letter to that office for comment.

3. Consideration as a part of the agenda of the Office of Development. If this prospectus is compelling enough, the Development Officer might start including YO in her discussion of activities on campus to donors around the world.

4. Guidance in the establishment of an endowment. We do not have the specifics yet of what having and drawing on an endowment entails. The baseline level for an endowment that Yale will administer, as of the fall of 2008, was $100,000.

5. Adjustment of funding regulations. UOFC and YCC regulations currently allow for funding only for club events on campus and for capital expenditures of $300. By the nature of our groups, most of our events occur off-campus, and nearly all our expenditures are for gear. Yale should recognize these two unique characteristics of an outing club, and adjust the regulations. YO and YMC have note received a response from UOFC on this issue (see letter on the next page). In 2009, for example, we did not receive funding for Winter School because the undergraduate committee decided that the program was too focused on off-campus activities.

6. A clear policy about trading meal plan swipes in the dining halls for weekend trips.

UOFC letter: No Response Received

PO Box 206185
New Haven, CT 06520

December 2, 2008

Bryan Twarek
Chair, UOFC
55 Whitney Avenue
New Haven, CT 06511

Dear Bryan:

We, the officers of the undergraduate outing clubs, Yale Outdoors and Yale Climbing Club, request an exemption from two sections of the Undergraduate Organization Funding Committee Funding Guidelines that hamper the activities of our groups.

The guidelines state that only future expenditures on "Capital Equipment Purchases" are to be considered. In addition, the guidelines establish a cap "per budget expense-item" of $300. We presume the reasoning behind this involves encouraging groups to use the capital equipment available through UOFC and discouraging them from exhausting their budgets on single items.

For several reasons, we believe that our groups should qualify for an exemption from these two guidelines.

First, our activities are highly dependent on capital equipment. While we hold many events on campus that UOFC funding helps pay for, the heart of what we do is to lead students on outdoor adventures off-campus. Because of the specialized equipment required for these adventures, we don't benefit from borrowing the capital equipment available through UOFC. Nor does it make sense for UOFC to buy gear like sleeping pads and bags, lightweight camp stoves, crampons, and climbing ropes—we would be the only groups using it. To a degree that we imagine is unique to our groups, what we do depends on our equipment.

Second, our capital equipment is particularly expensive. While we are diligent about sniffing out good gear sales throughout the year, there are some items whose prices never drop very low. For example, in the interest of pursuing snowshoing and skiing in the winter, Yale Outdoors is considering purchasing a winter tent—a tent designed to withstand high wind and snow loads. Even with a wholesale deal (25 percent off) through a local merchant we've developed a relationship with, a single such tent for three people will cost $430. This is an example of a particularly expensive piece of equipment, but we find ourselves continually running into limited resources to buy such equipment—without

which we are stuck as outdoor groups who must stay inside. The flexibility to spend more of our UOFC funding on such items would really help us.

Third, we try to minimize the cost of capital equipment by only buying items on sale or through wholesale deals. But gear sales online seldom coincide with UOFC funding deadlines to let us plan days or weeks in advance of purchasing gear. Most such sales last for a weekend, sometimes as long as a week, and it is hard to plan for them. More significantly, the best sales online, on sites like www.steepandcheap.com, are outlet store sales that cut prices on single items by 60-80 percent until they sell out. They tend to sell out in minutes. The winter tent mentioned above can suddenly become much more affordable: if our groups click the purchase button fast enough, we can easily get two or three times the equipment we could otherwise afford. But these are impossible expenditures to plan in advance. We have seen too many deals slide by, being unsure whether UOFC would reimburse us, and we would greatly benefit from the flexibility to take advantage of these sales when they appear.

We ask that UOFC consider this request for an exemption and respond to us so that we can start altering our funding applications.

We are simultaneously pursuing other means of paying for large capital expenditures, and we are prepared to ask our members to pay more for social events on campus so that we can devote a larger share of our budgets to gear acquisition.

Sincerely,

Spencer Gray TC ‘09
President, Yale Climbing Club
Treasurer, Yale Outdoors
spencer.gray@yale.edu

Eli Bildner DC ‘10
Coordinator, Yale Outdoors
elias.bildner@yale.edu

Raphael Magarik MC ‘10
Coordinator, Yale Outdoors
raphael.magarik@yale.edu

Logan Glickfield BR ‘10
Treasurer, Yale Climbing Club
logan.glickfield@yale.edu

V. Outdoor Life at Other Schools

A brief description of outdoor life at other universities is provided below as a means of comparison to Yale, though not in the interest of parity.

Princeton University

- One full-time staff member
- Gear office with storage space and low-priced rental options
- Rock wall
- Emphasis on outdoor education with at least one event every week on safety and/or various outdoor skills

University of Pennsylvania

- Funding for transportation and gear on a demonstrated-need basis
- Office on campus
- Lockers for gear in addition to larger storage space

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

- Independent non-profit corporation
- Office and gear room on campus
- Four vans for transportation
- Two cabins and boat house
- Education offerings including “winter school” program

University of Oregon

- Umbrella organization: all outdoor trips that are affiliated with University of Oregon are conducted through the UO Outdoor Program
- Staff: four full-time staff members; seven student staff members for the office; five student staff members for the barn, which houses all the equipment
- Funding: receives $275,000 a year. (The money comes from a student incidental fee of $180 per term. This money is allocated among a wide variety of student services.)
- Makes $30,000 a year through its rental program.
- The cost to participants is the actual shared expenses for the trip, such as gas, food, and equipment rental if necessary.
- Storage Space/Office: the UO Outdoor Program has an office and a separate storage space (called the Barn) for all its equipment.
- Transportation:
    - Option 1: UO Outdoor Program owns four vans (OP vehicles)
    - Option 2: State motor pool vehicles
  - Insurance:
    - Both the OP and State vehicles are covered by State of Oregon self insurance, with a $500 deductible. The deductible must be covered by the group using the van. An accident packet is in the door pocket on the vans, or in the glove box on other vehicles.
  - Cost:
    - The state motor pool has mini to 1-ton vans, with prices ranging from $30 to $65 a day in addition to gasoline. The OP GMC Safari (which holds 8) is $0.37 per mile with no daily charge while the larger 12 and 15 passenger vans are $0.48 per mile with no daily charge. The price difference between state vans and the OP van depends on how far you're going and how long you'll stay.

Brown University, Harvard, and Cornell

- On-campus spaces provided by administration dedicated to the student outdoor program.

VI. Miscellaneous

Brief History of Yale Mountaineering Club

by Jonathan Kreiss-Tomkins ‘12

Yale’s outdoor history is long and varied, although for the better part of the last century, the preeminent outdoor organization on Yale’s campus, indeed one of the preeminent outdoor organizations among U.S. universities, was the Yale Mountaineering Club. Prior to 1932, Yale had an informal “Outing Club” – minutes and notes from the club’s records show events that mostly consisted of modest backpacking trips and lectures on various exotic locales and mountain ranges. But that fall, the newly arrived class of ‘36 included a few students with a penchant for adventure and mischief. Between scaling Harkness Tower and other notable university edifices, this small group of students eventually focused their energies into a new organization on Yale’s campus: the Yale Mountaineering Club. For the rest of the ‘30s the club was relatively low-key, stealing off to crags and mountains throughout New England, and during the war years the club entered a brief hibernation.

With the war over in 1947, the club flourished. Fueled by an enthusiastic core of officers and a rapidly growing membership, the club expanded its scope, publishing an annual mountaineering journal and sponsoring expeditions throughout North America. Notable Mountaineering Club-sponsored expeditions from this era include exploration of the Front Range of Northern Colorado, exploration of the Brooks Range in the North Slope of Alaska, a pioneering ascent of Mount Wood (15,886 ft.) in the St. Elias Mountains of Alaska and the Yukon, and, perhaps most notably, one of the first documented expeditions into the Logan Mountains, a mountain range that demarcates the border between the Yukon and the Northwest Territories and is arguably one of the most remote and isolated regions in North America. This latter expedition produced a seminal glaciological survey of the area as YMC members collaborated with Yale’s geology department to collect field samples to analyze the geological origins of the area. Of course, as ardent mountaineers YMC members also logged nine first ascents of 9,000-10,000 foot glaciated peaks and granite spires in the range. More locally, the Mountaineering Club catalogued the 80-plus routes on Sleeping Giant just adjacent to New Haven and, in 1973, published *A Climber’s Guide to Ragged Mountain in Southington, Connecticut*.

The YMC was renamed the “Yale Climbing Club” in 2001, before returning to its original name in 2008. It continues to serve as the nexus of a climbing community of over 300 members.

YO-FOOT Initial Gear Sharing Agreement

GEAR SHARING AGREEMENT
BETWEEN YALE OUTDOORS AND YALE FRESHMAN OUTDOOR ORIENTATION TRIPS

(1) The organization Yale Freshman Outdoor Orientation Trips (FOOT) grants Yale Outdoors (YO; registered name: "Outdoors Club, Yale College") temporary usage of 20 backpacks, 10 sleeping bags, and 10 sleeping pads from its inventory for the purpose of renting it to participants in YO's first annual Winter School.

(2) Period of usage.
Depending on the success of this temporary usage, under its own discretion FOOT may extend the period of usage to YO. At the end of the month of February, 2009, FOOT and YO will communicate about the extension or completion of the period of usage.

(3) Serialization.
FOOT gear not already marked adequately will be marked by YO with a sharpie indicating it to be the property of FOOT. This serialization will be included on a spreadsheet of YO gear being rented to participants on outing trips in order to track its use and to accrue rental fees to FOOT.

(4) Storage.
FOOT gear will be stored along with other YO gear in the basement storage room of Entryway C in Davenport College. The Master's Office of Davenport College (DC) has agreed to reserve this room for part of the spring semester of 2009 for the exclusive use of YO, specifically as a rental location for Winter School. A single key to this room is available to YO Co-Coordinator Eli Bildner (DC 2010) on a daily basis through the DC Master's Office.

(5) Access.
YO leaders and affiliated Winter School leaders will access the gear storage room during office hours in the month of February, Mondays 6-7 and Thursdays 9-midnight, with groups of participants in Winter School. YO leaders will staff the room: they will sign out both YO and FOOT gear, collect appropriate deposits, and collect rental fees and (if necessary) late and damage fees on return of the gear.

(6) Rental.
FOOT gear will be included on the inventory of YO gear available to participants in Winter School trips. YO will collect a security deposit in the form of a check, or in the case of a lack of checks, credit card information will be taken from renters. On the return of gear, renters will pay relevant rental fees based on a daily usage rate. If renters return gear late they will be fined based on a daily late fee. If they do not return gear, their deposit check will be cashed. The deposits for FOOT gear (including relevant stuff sacks) are as follows: sleeping bags ($250), sleeping pads ($25), backpacks ($300). The rental fees per day of use are as follows: sleeping bags ($4), sleeping pad ($1), backpacks ($5).

(7) Rental fees for FOOT
YO will write a check to FOOT either at the end of February, 2009, or at a later undetermined date, for the total rental fees assessed for FOOT equipment. The determination of the date of this payment will be made following further communication between YO and FOOT.

(8) Cleaning and maintenance.
Cleaning is the responsibility of renters. A fee will be assessed for turning in dirty gear. Any gear ultimately returned to the YO inventory dirty will be cleaned by the leaders of YO or affiliated Winter School leaders in appropriate fashion.

_____ _____
Signature of representative of FOOT Date

_____ _____
Signature of representative of YO Date

END